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Wellington & District

LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Eucharanea, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbron and Yeoval districts.

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WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

Wellington Boot Carnival

Time to book your Boot Tent

Scabbing Flat Bridge

Public Meeting - P3

Finally we have new amenities at Pioneer Park

- P7

More of Walmer's history, local schools

- P 10

Our Clair a Sydney Royal finalist

BY MARK GRIGGS

WELLINGTON SHOW’s 2025 Young Woman of the Year, Clair Stiff, never wondered that a ribbon at her local show would have as far-reaching consequences as becoming a finalist at Sydney Royal Show.

Last Saturday evening Clair with Blayney Show’s Eva Price and Forbes’ Libby Coles, were announced Zone 6 finalists heading for The Land 2026 Sydney Royal Show Young Woman of the Year.

Eugowra Show Society hosted the event which drew 21 finalists from throughout the Central West and Orana regions.

Clair said her plans of grooming and parading Poll Herefords during the ‘Royal’ had quickly changed.

“Instead of parading the cattle it will be me and the other finalists parading around the Sydney showground and meeting other people, which will be amazing,” she said.

“It will be a busy week, but rewarding.”

“I was to go down with Michelle and Luke Cross of Glenalvie Poll Hereford stud, and Bev and Allan Hutchinson of Kalnee Park Poll Hereford stud from Wellington.”

Finalist judges were Karen Bailey of The Land, Phil Lemieus of PSC Insurance and Jody Nelson-Gleeson, Vice-president AgShows NSW, while Caddie Marshall was the after-dinner onstage interviewer.

Clair said the event started with a luncheon in the new community centre which was built after the November 22 devastating floods that literally wiped-out much of the town.

Interviews began after lunch and continued throughout the afternoon.

“We had a little bit of a conversation at first, asked questions about Wellington – what’s so great about the community, then some discussion about the concerns in the world and linking that back to Wellington,” she said.

“Then a little bit about the 150th Wellington Show coming up, and the committee working hard to get some major events happening.

“The show is organising a reunion of as many former Showgirls and Young Women as it can going back to 1963.

“I was also asked about renewable energy and how that linked to agriculture and linking that back to Wellington which has become a hub for solar and wind farms and associated infrastructure.”

“Myself and the girls were hosted at homes throughout the town to prepare for the Ball and Dinner that evening which was incredible.”

Clair said it was so interesting that the whole of Eugowra came together and helped with this zone final.

After dinner all girls were interviewed on stage then lined up for the finalists’ announcements.

“On stage I was asked specific questions on my research, which is amazing how that links to AgShows and agriculture in general,” she said.

“I think the amount of awareness that I’ve been able to distribute on Endometriosis and women’s health issues in agriculture in general has been wonderful.



Wellington Show’s Clair Stiff was selected to be one of the three Zone 6 finalists in 2026 The Land Sydney Royal Show Young Woman of the Year last Saturday evening at Eugowra.

“I had so many women come up to me and show their support for the study and all the things that I’m doing as well as asking questions about it and trying to raise their concerns as well.

“So, I think that was something that really stood out to me.

“No matter whether I’m successful as the state’s Young Woman or not, I think in my eyes it’s getting the

awareness out there and feeling the support is good enough for me. This is so exciting, Sydney will be amazing.

“I’m really happy that I joined the competition and now aim to encourage other young women to get involved this year in Wellington.

“That’s my next goal - to get other young women to enter the local competition. It’s a great journey and I’m sure they will love it as much as I have.”

Inside this week

Cumnock & District Merino Flock Ewe Competition report and photos - Page 4

Scabbing Flat Bridge meeting well attended

THERE WAS a big crowd of at least 80 people in attendance at the Geurie Bowlo on Monday afternoon to meet with the new Transport for NSW Director regarding the issue of the replacement of Scabbing Flat Bridge, Geurie.

The Timber Truss Bridge Conservation Strategy governs what happens with the remaining timber truss bridges in NSW.

This policy is currently under review by Transport for NSW, principally due to the actions and representations of the Geurie community.

Having this policy changed is the best way to see a new concrete bridge built to replace Scabbing Flat Bridge.

Transport for NSW is hoping to have the policy review completed by the middle of this year.

Touch Football Carnival returns in 2027

The three Wellington teams that competed in the NSW Touch Junior State Cup Northern Conference Carnival in Dubbo recently will be happy that in 2027 they only need to travel as far as Dubbo to compete in the

comp again after Dubbo was awarded hosting rights for another year.

This is a big win for Council, the regional community who benefit from spending in the visitor economy, and for local players who don't need incur the cost of travel in order to compete.

Bin Collection delays

As people would know, this last week has seen a delay in emptying wheelie bins.

This was caused by the contractor JR Richards having six drivers all off sick at the same time, and then the relief drivers from Council who are trained and can fill-in when required were also unwell.

Online Community Survey – now open

The Community survey is open online now for EVERYONE. Calls as part of the Community Insight Survey are now complete, and our online survey is now open.

This survey is your chance to share what matters most, tell us about your experiences with Council's services and facilities, and help shape how well we're meeting the

community's expectations.

Completing this survey will take approximately 10 minutes, and your feedback is greatly valued.

To start the survey, google 'Dubbo Regional Council Your Say Community Survey'. This survey closes at 9am on Monday 30 March 2026.

More Community Grant money

The first round of the ACEREZ Community Grants Program is expected to open to applications in March.

Small grants between \$3000 to \$50,000 and significant grants between \$50,000 to \$1 million will be available to support projects that focus on public amenity, agriculture, education, health, sports and Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities. Eligible applicants in the Dubbo Regional Council and Mid-Western Regional Council areas are invited to attend an information session to get an overview of the program.

Bulky Rubbish Collection Service Survey – Closes soon

In July 2024, Council introduced a trial of a new, bookable bulky rubbish collection service. We're seeking feedback until Tuesday, 10 March 2026 from eligible residents who have not used the service, to understand any barriers to booking the service and to inform future decisions about how bulky rubbish collection services are delivered. Take the survey today at Your Say on the Council webpage to help Councilors make an informed decision.

Residential Rehabilitation Centre – a step closer

Very topical for people of this region is the construction of a Residential Alcohol and Other Drugs Rehabilitation Centre in Dubbo. It has been confirmed that Renascent Australia is appointed as the main works contractor the facility following competitive tendering.

This is a significant milestone bringing us one step closer to delivering critical health infrastructure and support for people who want to address their substance dependence and safely reintegrate into the community.

Josh Black

Chuckles Corner

State-wide fight against potholes: Half a million fixed under Minns Labor Government, more than 106,500 filled in seven months across regional NSW

THE MINNS Labor Government is taking the fight to potholes across New South Wales, with more than 106,500 potholes repaired on roads in regional NSW this financial year.

The repair blitz highlights the Government's focus on getting the basics right – putting road maintenance and safety first, particularly in the wake of persistent and severe weather events.

Since March 2023, the Minns Government has filled more than 500,000 potholes, lifting the

share of pothole-free state-managed roads across regional NSW to 82 per cent – a notable increase to conditions after 12 years of neglect under the previous government.

From local main streets to nationally significant corridors, the fight is on to make journeys smoother, safer and more reliable for regional communities.

Across regional NSW, crews are on the ground every day, and they're fixing defects early before small problems become bigger, costlier failures.

The workforce includes some of the 71 new apprentices and trainees recently deployed by Transport for NSW, now getting to work supporting frontline maintenance and fixing roads across the state.

But we aren't stopping here.

Work is supported by \$155 million in accelerated funding, boosting the regional road maintenance budget to \$1.25 billion this year.

Since July 2025, more than 1400 small but important uplift projects have been delivered across regional state-managed roads – including intersection improvements, shoulder sealing, drainage upgrades, localised repaving and targeted safety treatment.

The Minns Government is working hard to ensure people feel the difference: fewer bumps, safer verges, clearer markings, stronger surfaces.

Editor's note:
The Leader published this as we knew it would give readers a bit of a chuckle.

Not sure the Mitchell Highway users from Wellington to Dubbo would agree when the same sections have been reworked up to three times.

Then there are gravel road users (which are probably council roads) that are still waiting for a grading since amalgamation, like 12 Mile Road after the Wuuluman windfarm turnoff.

Farm fire fighting failure

THE NSW Opposition has called out the State Government's failed Farm Fire Fighting Vehicle scheme after it was revealed just 66 vehicles are registered to the program.

The Farm Fire Fighting Vehicle scheme was proposed following the Black Summer Bushfires to allow quicker response times in remote and rural areas.

The scheme was intended to allow unregistered firefighting assets that reside on farms, such as old trucks and water trailers, to use public roads in the case of an emergency by providing conditional registration.

Scott Barrett MLC said this should have been a very simple scheme allowing farmers to help their communities in times of need but instead we've been left with an overly bureaucratic paper pushing exercise.

"Many farmers want to be part of this scheme, but not if it's too onerous and costly which it clearly is," Mr Barrett said.

"This fantastic idea has been ruined by trial overload and a substandard registration system leaving us with just a handful of people willing to take part in the scheme across the state."

The scheme was trialled in the Summer of 2023/24 with a commitment from the Minns Labor Government to make the scheme permanent before the next bushfire season.

A second trial was

announced during the following bushfire season after extensive lobbying from Mr Barrett and inaction from Labor to fulfill the promise of making the scheme permanent.

Shadow Minister for Emergency Services Tanya Thompson said the first trial had 211 participants, and the second trial 148 - proving a high level of interest in the scheme.

"These are farmers

who want to do the right thing and help their community, they should be encouraged at every step," Mrs Thompson said.

"From these numbers alone, it's clear the Government has again bungled the rollout of a critical emergency services measure in regional NSW showing they don't understand the regions and don't understand the issues we are facing."

The price of a "Leader" is only half the cost of a coffee

Wellington & District LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O'Brien

Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Euchareena to Elong Elong within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

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Funeral Notice

RICH, Mark Edward

31st August 1962 – 1st March 2026

Passed away peacefully at Wellington Hospital. Dearly loved husband of Debby. Much loved father of Michael and Gavin. Loved brother of Robert, Trevor (deceased), Peter (deceased), Donald (deceased) and Debbie.

“Rest In Peace”
Aged 64 years

The family and friends of **Mark** are kindly invited to attend his Funeral Service to be held at **Wellington Uniting Church, 105 Arthur St on Thursday March 12, 2026 commencing at 11am.**

At the conclusion of the service the cortege will proceed to the Wellington Lawn Cemetery.

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“We just want a new bridge!”

Locals frustrated with bureaucracy

By Mark Griggs, WDL and Tony Graham, Binjang Community Radio

POLITE FRUSTRATION could be the term used describing the 70-plus attendees of the Scabbing Flat Bridge public meeting on Monday afternoon at Geurie Bowling Club.

Frustration, because many of the questions of upwards of 15 people went unanswered or taken negatively by the sole Transport for NSW representative, Damien Pfeiffer, Executive Director, Partnerships and Integration – West Regional Integration Planning, Integration and Passenger.

As well as many farmers, business and interested people attending, Scabbing Flat Bridge Action Committee chair Michelle Tomkins was accompanied by local state member Dugald Saunders, DRC mayor Josh Black, deputy-mayor Phillip Toynton, councillor Richard Ivey and DRC acting general manager, Luke Ryan.

Ms Tomkins said feedback from the meeting in general was pretty negative. “Even one local, Tracey Rushton stated that everything put forward gained a negative answer.

“So, it sounds as though you have already made your decision,” she said.

Mr Pfeiffer described a new process underway with a review into timber truss bridges throughout the state primarily with a “fit for purpose” filter.

The future of Scabbing Flat Bridge will be determined at the end of this process towards the end of June this year, however there will be no community consultation in the process.

However, Ms Tomkins said her concern with the new review The concern I have with the review is that they (the department) were going down the exact same path as last time.

“The last review in 2012 where heritage was the focus, and this time the review is less public than what it was in 2012,” she said.

“There’ll be no community consultation. “So, I asked where’s the economic assessment, the productivity assessment, and safety assessments.

“This has to be a balanced review.”

She said Mr Pfeiffer assured us it would be a balanced review.

“He answered they would look at economics, productivity and safety which would be done internally in his department and would look at other departments for support,” Ms Tomkins said.

Clr Richard Ivey suggested that in parallel with the review in to lifting the heritage order, preliminary planning should be undertaken now for siting a new bridge to save time on the inevitable requirement for a new bridge.

He called for a feasibility and costing study to be implemented as soon as possible.

However, that was responded with a can’t do, Ms Tomkins said.

She said they were told the bridge reconstruction would take six months, but it’s now two years.

“We were originally told when the bailey bridge was gone, it was never coming back.

“It’s coming back.

“If they want the heritage bridge to remain, that’s fine, but we need a new bridge to meeting today’s needs.”



Minimum age to ride an e-bike is a path to safer streets

A MINIMUM age to ride an e-bike in NSW is being introduced as part of the State Government’s measured and staged reforms aimed at improving safety for riders, pedestrians and the wider community.

NSW will also adopt the European safety and performance standard to ensure e-bikes perform like bicycles, and the current crop of high-powered, illegal motorbikes masquerading as e-bikes are removed from the state’s roads and footpaths.

There are an estimated 760,000 e-bikes in NSW.

The rapid growth has brought new opportunities for people to get around and to keep active, but it’s highlighted the need for clearer, more consistent rules to support their safe use.

The reforms being introduced recognise the law needs to keep pace with the popularity of e-bikes while ensuring families and riders who have already purchased devices are treated fairly.

We believe this approach strikes the right balance: improving safety for riders and the wider community, while preserving e-bikes as an accessible and popular form of everyday transport.

Minimum age

Under current NSW Road Rules, a child of any age can ride an e-bike and bicycle riders of any age can carry passengers if the bike’s design allows.

E-bikes are heavier and faster than traditional bicycles, which can increase the force involved in a crash, heighten the risk of serious injury, and make them more difficult to control and manoeuvre.

An expert review led by Transport for NSW will recommend a legal minimum age between 12 and 16 for riding an e-bike in NSW, while also considering whether children and teenagers have the skills, maturity and awareness of potential dangers required to safely carry passengers.

As part of this review there will be consultation with experts in child development and road safety, including the NSW Office for Youth and Young People, and will listen directly to parents and young people before making a final decision on the appropriate age threshold.

Advice and findings will be provided to the Minister for Transport and Minister for Roads by June, with the NSW Government to make a final decision on an age limit and passengers.

Age limit restrictions will build on e-bike reforms already announced by the government, including:

- * New powers for NSW Police to seize and crush illegal e-bikes.

- * A trial of portable ‘dyno units’ to measure e-bike speed in roadside compliance checks.

- * Tearing up the former Liberal government’s 2023 decision to allow 500-watt e-bikes on NSW roads.

- * Introduced new standards for lithium-ion batteries to reduce the risk of fires associated with e-bikes and e-scooters.

NSW will adopt the EU Safety Standard

NSW will adopt the European safety standard (EN15194) in March this year to ensure e-bikes operate like bicycles, and not motorbikes.

Under this standard, e-bikes

must have a maximum power output of 250 watts and power assistance must cut out at 25km/h. No power assistance is delivered at all after 6km/h if a rider is not pedalling the bike.

The standard also includes strict battery, electrical and fire-safety requirements, as well as anti-tampering protections to prevent power and speed limits being altered. NSW will join only Western Australia in requiring this benchmark, giving riders clearer rules and stronger safety protections.

A Practical Transition

Recognising hundreds of thousands of e-bikes currently in use were purchased legally under the former Liberal National Government’s 2023 rule change, which increased the allowable power from 250 watts to 500 watts, a three-year transition period will apply.

From 1 March 2029, only e-bikes meeting the European standard will be road legal in NSW.

The three-year period reflects the typical lifespan of an e-bike and provides households, retailers and manufacturers with certainty and time to adjust.

However, after a period of consultation, retailers will be required to clearly specify whether a bike meets the EU standard and is therefore road legal in NSW.

The Government will also work closely with manufacturers to ensure future stock complies with the updated rules.

The reforms provide clarity and certainty: compliant bikes remain legal and accessible; higher-powered devices will need to meet higher regulatory

requirements.

This is a staged, practical reform that recognises the reality on our streets while steadily moving toward a safer and more consistent framework for the future.



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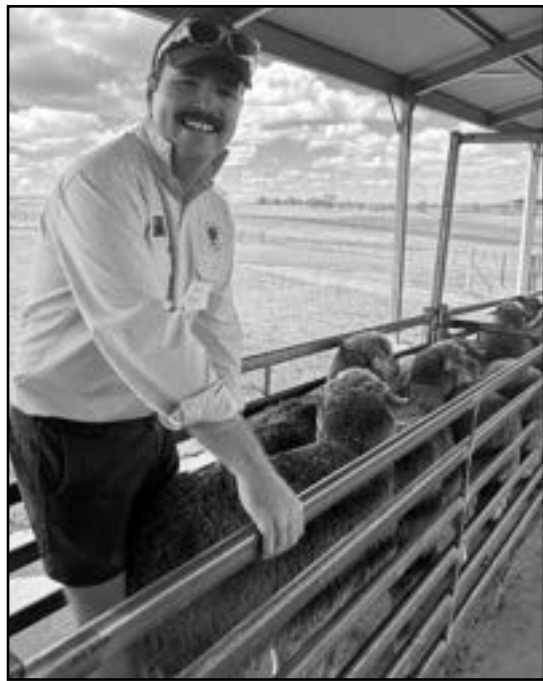
Merino flock ewes feature of Cumnock district competition attracting enthusiastic onlookers



Judges Alistair Keller, Elders Stud Stock, SA, and Angus Munro, Mendooran with Phil Salter, “Greydene”, Gumble (centre) who had a line of Roseville Park-blood Merino ewes on display.



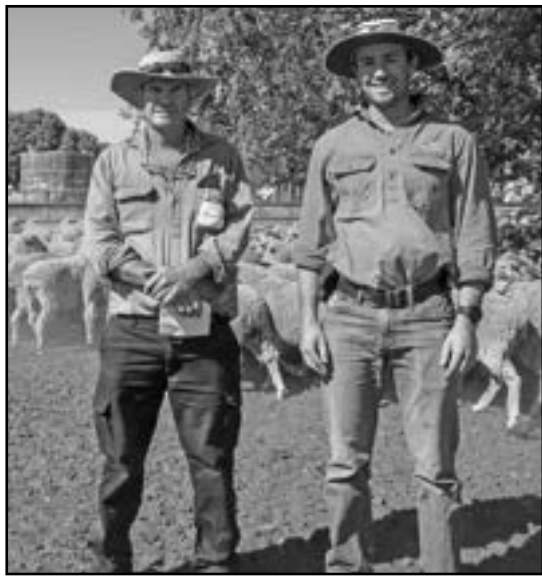
At Boomey Park, Larras Lee are Angus Shannon, Angus Munro, Alistair Keller, Russell Jones of Darriwell and Tom Kirk.



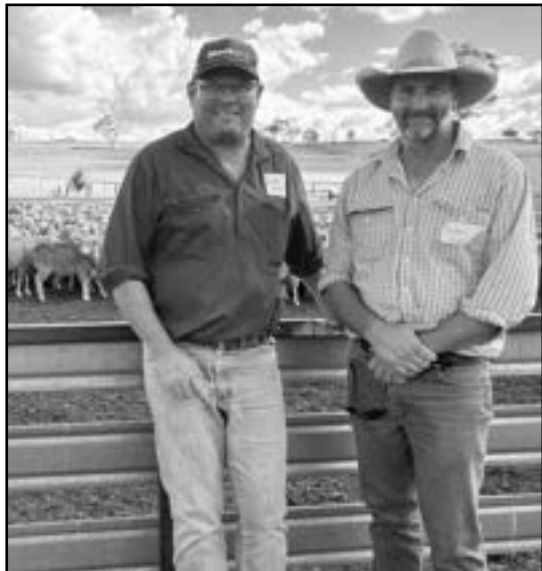
Jack Dodds at Oaklands with Gullen Gamble/ Aloeburn blood ewes.



Andrew Foster at Gundabooka, Cumnock.



John and Henry Hickson, Eural Pastoral Co, “Castle Hill”, Baldry moved to the district approximately one year ago and entered a run of their Merino ewes in the competition.



Gordon Welsh and Andrew Heath among their Larras Lake ewes at Larras Lee.

ANOTHER SUCCESSFUL day of viewing nine Merino flocks among the best in the Central West was held last Thursday, February 26.

Conducted by Cumnock Show Society, the 2026 Cumnock and District Flock Ewe Field Day attracted upwards of 70 visitors who travelled on the bus or by private vehicle throughout the day.

This year the flocks were judged by Alistair Keller, Elders Stud Stock Manager for South Australia, and Angus Munro of Mendooran who is co-running a Border Leicester stud and commercial Merino operation, and a former manager at Poll Boonoke Merino stud, Deniliquin.

Winners

Four commercial flocks were placed from the nine entries with Phil and Anne Salter of Greydene, Gumble, placed the winning flock.

The Salters have supported the competition since its inception and their Roseville Park blood flock classes by Alan Clarke of Dubbo, was placed second in 2023 and third in 2024.

They retained 720 of the 850-ewe drop in 2024 and run some 2000 head growing an average 18+ micron wool.

Second placing went to another long-time competition supporter Peter and Odette Morley and family whose Boomey Park flock north of Larras Lee is managed by Angus Shannon and classed by Michael Elmes.

The flock has been on Darriwell blood for decades and in 2024 retained 1400 of the 2300 ewe drop.

The Boomey Park flock of near 4000 ewes grow an average 20-micron fleece.

Yeoval’s Philipson family running their Ballot Box flock for generations, and represented by Matthew Philipson, was placed third.

His 3600-ewe flock has been on Westray blood for some time and classed by Blake Cannon of Westray. In 2024 retained 1100 of 1600 ewes dropped.

Another Yeoval operation run by the Tremain family combined flocks of Kynuna and Yennora of Brett and Nicole, and Ailee and Lynsey who over the past five years have used Hazeldean with Roseville Park and Lachlan blood, were given the encouragement award.

They kept 721 of their 2024 ewe drop of 765 and grow 19.5-micron wool.



Judges Angus Munro and Alistair Keller, with Matthew Philipson, “Ballot Box”, Yeoval (centre) and his Westray Park-blood Merino ewes.



Ailee and Lynsey Tremain with their family’s Merino ewes on display. The Tremain’s run approximately 30,000 sheep between their Yeoval and Blackall, Qld, properties.



Merino ewes on display at Brett and Nicole Tremain’s Yeoval property.

Even familiar crossings can be fatal.



You know this road.

You've crossed it hundreds of times.
But when it comes to rail crossings, being
too familiar or complacent can be fatal.

No matter how well you know the way,
never assume the tracks are clear.
Because making sure, means making it home.

Slow down. Look. Listen for trains.

Acerez grants open ‘Fire sale’ of regional Defence assets must be reversed

APPLICATIONS ARE open for the first round of the ACEREZ Community Grants Program.

The three-year program provides funding for grassroots projects that bring communities together and make neighbourhoods stronger and more connected.

There are two types of grants available:

- * Small community grants: \$3000 up to \$50,000
- * Significant community grants: \$50,000 up to \$1 million

Priority funding areas are:

- * Public amenity: Support for community facilities to enhance safety and local services
- * Agriculture: Programs to support land and agricultural management
- * Education: Initiatives to enhance outcomes for young people and inter-generational learning
- * Health: Programs to support physical health, mental health, and wellbeing
- * Sports: Grassroots sport initiatives

for community inclusion

* Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities: Initiatives to improve outcomes for First Nations communities

Up to \$4 million will be available across two grant rounds this year and people and organisations are encouraged to submit an application early.

Free grant writing assistance is available to make the application process as easy as possible.

Find all the information needed on the website, including an application form at www.acerez.com.au/community.

Applications for the ACEREZ Community Grants Program will initially be assessed by a Community Advisory Group to provide local input and ensure proposed initiatives are viable, inclusive and fit-for-purpose.

ACEREZ will consider recommendations from the Advisory Group when making its final funding decisions.

I AM totally opposed to the fire sale of our regional defence assets, as proposed by the Federal Government.

Our veterans don’t support it, our Australian Defence Force personnel don’t support it, and I don’t support it either.

It is a very shortsighted move that must be reversed.

Racecourse Barracks in Bathurst (Bathurst Stores Training Depot) is home to our local Army Reserve unit, the 1/19th, also known as the ‘Bushman’s Rifles’.

While this unit is intended to be drawn from people right across Western New South Wales, closing and selling off our Bathurst barracks will effectively lock out local residents from serving.

At a time when our Army and our Army Reserve are crying out for recruits, the government is suddenly making it significantly harder for our reservists and members of the Bushman’s Rifles to actually attend training.

It simply does not make any sense.

This decision is also fundamentally wrong-headed from a historical and practical perspective.

During World War II, Racecourse Barracks served as a repair depot for armoured vehicles.

Local veterans have informed me that there are all sorts of stuff buried on that site, so they’re not going to make a big return on it anyway.

It is baffling that we would decimate our local reserve units just to save on some lawnmowing fees.

In the current climate of regional conflict and instability across the globe, we are going to need this site.

The facility already boasts first-rate accommodation for approximately 80 people, lecture rooms, and a first-class modern armoury.

On the broader scale, our veterans are absolutely furious that the government is also selling Victoria Barracks in Sydney, the historic home of the Army in New South Wales.

For relatively small return, the government is willing to trade away our military history and the infrastructure that means so much to our veterans.

If we want our Army and Army Reserve units like the Bushman’s Rifles to stay strong, you’ve actually got to invest in the bases, the depots and the barracks to keep it that way.

You’ve got to make it easy for people to get to training.

You’ve got to have places where people can come together to train together.

This is a very poor decision. The government needs to change course on this and they’re going to be hearing a lot more from me on this issue.



GRANT LISTING RESOURCES

- Australian Government**
- * GrantConnect – The official Australian Government grants register, listing all current and forecast Commonwealth grant opportunities. <https://www.grants.gov.au>
 - * Business Grants & Programs Finder (business.gov.au) – A guided search tool covering Federal, state and local government grants and assistance programs. <https://business.gov.au/grants-and-programs>
 - * Community Grants Hub – A portal for community-focused grants delivered on behalf of various government departments. <https://www.communitygrants.gov.au> State and Territory Government Grants
- NSW Government**
- Grants and Funding – A central listing of NSW Government grants and funding programs. <https://www.nsw.gov.au/grants-and-funding> Community and Not-for-Profit Grant Listings
- * Open Grants (The Centre for Volunteering) – Regularly updated listings of open grants for volunteer and community organisations. <https://www.volunteering.com.au/open-grants>
 - * The Funding Centre – A free grants database covering government, philanthropic and corporate funding opportunities. <https://www.fundingcentre.com.au>
- Additional Helpful Resources**
- * Our Community – Information, tools and guidance to support community groups and grant applicants. <https://www.ourcommunity.com.au>
 - * SmartyGrants – A grants management platform used by many funders; access to applications is free when grants are open. <https://www.smarty-grants.com.au>

Winter crops recover with 20pc rise in value for 2024-25

* **Australian Agriculture: Broad-acre Crops, 2024-25 financial year**

PRODUCERS SOLD 61.1 million tonnes of winter broadacre crops in 2024-25, according to the latest insights from the Australian Bureau of Statistics (ABS).

Trent Lind, ABS head of agriculture statistics, said winter crop production rose 22 per cent in 2024-25.

“This increase led to a 20pc rise in the value of winter crops sold, coming in at \$22.5 billion dollars for local producers,” Mr Lind said.

“Roughly 2pc of the reported increase in value reflects the addition of faba bean and field pea statistics, which are being published for the first time using the ABS’ modernised approach.

“Even with the significant growth in 2024-25, the tonnage and value of produce sold remains lower than the record highs seen in the 2022-23 financial year.”

The bumper crops that year of 68.6 million tonnes sold at a local value of \$26.3 billion.

While wheat, barley and canola (statistics/industry/agriculture/australian-agriculturebroadacre-crops/2024-25#winter-broadacre-crops) continue to account for most winter crops sold (9pc combined), chickpeas had the largest rise with 2.0 million tonnes sold in 2024-25.

This is up from 0.5 million tonnes sold the year before.

“Local producers sold \$1.7 billion worth of chickpeas in 2024-25, up from \$0.4 billion in 2023-24,” Mr Lind said.

“The huge growth for chickpea production was driven by ideal growing conditions and higher international demand following India’s temporary suspension of tariffs on the crop.”

More districts were the highest producing area for both chickpeas and wheat, also leading total grains production.

‘Area specific insights for crop production, including two new crops in faba beans and fieldpeas, are now available as ABS continues to modernise agricultural statistics.



with **Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld**

FOR YEARS I’ve been fascinated by how quickly our wearables have evolved.

I still remember being told that if you wanted accurate heart-rate data, you’d need to strap on an uncomfortable chest band.

Now we casually glance at a watch that tracks our pulse, runs an ECG, estimates blood oxygen, monitors skin temperature and sleep breathing, and even offers clues about blood pressure and blood sugar trends.

What once sounded like science fiction now sits on our wrists next to yesterday’s coffee stain.

It’s a reminder of how far sensor technology has come. Smaller chips, smarter software, better batteries and a lot of creative thinking have transformed clunky medical gear into sleek, everyday accessories.

Devices that would have been impossible a decade ago are now sold alongside phone chargers.

But even with all that progress, I never expected one particular topic to make its way into this column.

So forgive me in advance for using a word

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rarely seen in polite tech commentary.

We now have a wearable sensor designed to track farts.

Yes, really.

It may not be a subject that gets much air-time - especially in confined spaces like elevators - but behind the giggles lies some surprisingly serious science.

Researchers have developed what’s cheekily dubbed a “Fitbit for farts”: a small, battery-powered device that clips discreetly to clothing and measures hydrogen gas released during flatulence.

It’s part of a broader effort to understand digestive health in ways that, until now, simply weren’t possible.

As odd as it sounds, this little gadget represents the cutting edge of several powerful technology trends.

First, there’s miniaturisation. Hydrogen sensors once belonged in industrial labs, connected to bulky equipment. Now they can be shrunk down to a device barely larger than a few stacked coins.

Second, there’s continuous monitoring - the

same principle that allows your smartwatch to track your heart rate all day.

And third, there’s edge computing, meaning the device processes much of its data on the spot rather than constantly sending everything to the cloud.

Why hydrogen? Because much of the gas produced by the microbes in our gut contains it.

By measuring hydrogen concentration over time, researchers can estimate both the frequency and volume of flatulence. And while that might sound trivial, it fills a genuine gap in medical knowledge.

We know more about the variety of gases produced by cows than we do by humans.

Digestive discomfort affects a huge portion of adults.

Bloating and excessive wind are common reasons people abandon high-fibre diets, even though fibre is strongly linked to lower risks of bowel disease and improved overall health.

The early results are fascinating. One person, who I can only assume is not that pop-

ular, was recorded as having up to 175 wind events per day. Another as little as four daily emissions.

The engineering challenge alone with this device is impressive.

To build a wearable hydrogen sensor, developers had to rethink power consumption, using ultra-efficient chips similar to those found in wireless earbuds.

The device needs to run all day on a tiny battery, recharge easily and remain unobtrusive. Not long ago, that combination simply wasn’t feasible.

As much as we have been measuring our body from the outside, the gut may be the next frontier.

Technology is no longer just counting our steps or timing our runs; it’s venturing into the awkward, unspoken corners of biology.

And perhaps that’s the point. As sensors become smaller and smarter, nothing about our bodies is beyond measurement.

Who knows – the path to better health may well begin with a little hot air and few unpleasant odours.

Pioneer Park amenities block officially opens

THE LONG-AWAITED Pioneer Park Amenities building has been completed, and finally officially opened last Thursday.

Mayor Josh Black with deputy mayor Phillip Toynton and Cllr Richard Ivey performed the official ceremony last Thursday.

Now local sporting groups, particularly the Warriors Soccer Club and junior cricketers can get back to some regularity on sporting days and weekends with change rooms, toilets, kiosk and storage rooms back in place.

Young vandals set fire to the previous building which destroyed close to a quarter of a million dollars-worth of soccer equipment and team sponsored jerseys, that had been rescued from the Warriors container after being washed down the Bell River in the November 2022 flood.

So, hopefully, things will be back to normal for the sporting clubs once again.



Bryan Fry selected as AWI CEO

AUSTRALIAN WOOL Innovation has announced Bryan Fry will be the next Chief Executive Officer, effective 9th March 2026.

AWI Chairman George Millington said the decision by the Board followed an extensive recruitment process.

“Bryan brings global leadership experience, most recently serving as Chairman and Global Chief Executive Officer of Pernod Ricard Winemakers, where he led large-scale, international operations across multiple markets and premium brands,” he said.



His career is distinguished by a rare combination of hands-on agricultural experience as an agronomist alongside deep expertise in international marketing, brand development and commercial strategy.

This unique blend of skills positions him strongly to lead the research, development and marketing organisation for Australian woolgrowers.

Bryan’s background in agriculture, coupled with his proven global leadership and brand expertise, makes him exceptionally well suited to lead the organisation.

“I would also like to thank John Roberts for his outstanding leadership as CEO since October 2021. During his tenure, John has delivered strategic focus, and strong performance for the organisation and industry alike. John will work closely with Bryan to ensure a thorough and seamless handover, supporting continuity and ongoing momentum,” Mr Millington said.

Bryan Fry said he was looking forward to commencing the role and working closely with stakeholders across the industry.

“I am excited to join AWI and to help deliver better outcomes both on and off farm. Australian wool is by far the best natural fibre in the world and I am looking forward to playing my part in securing an even brighter future for woolgrowers and the wider industry.”

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Church Services

Anglican Parish of Wellington

WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist Church

Sunday 9am

Sunday 5pm - The Gathering

MARANATHA

11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church

77 Swift Street

9:30am Sunday mornings

6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church

Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick’s Catholic Parish

Saturday

6pm – Mass, St Patrick’s Church, Wellington

8.30am - Stuart Town

Sunday

8am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month

10am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month

10am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays of the month

8am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington second and fourth Sundays of the month

Weekday mass

Please check parish bulletin

In Christ Chapel

2pm Sunday

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Around the electorate

with our State Member **Dugald Saunders**



Anne’s community spirit recognised
LAST WEEK I had the pleasure of presenting a NSW Community Service Award to the Sing Out Choir’s co-founder, Anne Gemmell, in recognition of her work to improve the quality of life of people living with dementia.
Armed with a background as a dementia counsellor, an understanding of the power of music and determination to make a difference, Anne was instrumental in getting the very first all-inclusive dementia choir west of the Blue Mountains up and running.
What began with 25 members has now grown into a thriving weekly event with more than 170 regular participants and over 30 volunteers. Sing Out Choir is not just a choir - it’s a community filled with love, joy, belonging and hope.
The NSW Government Community Service Award is an opportunity for Members of Parliament to recognise individuals in their community who have helped to improve the quality of life of others.
Anne truly embodies the spirit of commu-

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nity service, and for that she is more than worthy of this award. Congratulations Anne!

Constituent Spotlight
After a history-making win at the NSW Touch Football Junior State Cup – Northern Conference in Dubbo a fortnight ago, Dubbo Touch Association’s U10 Boys have done it again by taking out the win at the State Cup Final.
Undefeated throughout the whole season, the boys can now confidently say that they are the best in NSW, and their win was made even sweeter by confirmation that the Junior Northern Conference will return to Dubbo next February.
Congratulations to the boys and a big shout out to their families and support team in Adam Gray, Loch Murphy and Kimberley Forrester.

Young Woman with a mission
A huge congratulations also goes to Wellington’s Clair Stiff, who has been announced as one of the three Zone 6 finalists who will be going on to compete in the Young Women Competition at the Sydney Royal Easter Show!

Clair was joined by Dubbo’s Hope Spears-Hoogers and Narromine’s Chantelle Tedder at the Zone 6 Finals in Eugowra over the weekend, where they each participated in one-on-one interviews and a final luncheon before the formal dinner on Saturday evening.
Each of these young ladies is so deserving of their place as local Young Woman, and they should be very proud of the leadership, passion and community spirit they’ve shown throughout the 2025/26 competition.
Well done and good luck, Clair!

Washing Machine program returns
The popular Washing Machine Exchange Program is back to help eligible low-income households upgrade their inefficient top-loading washing machines.
To be eligible, NSW residents must:
* be more than 18 years old,* hold a valid, eligible concession card from Centrelink or the Department of Veterans’ Affairs* have an existing top-loading washing machine to exchange, not have participated in the 2022 or 2025 rounds. Successful applicants will be required to pay \$250 for the front load wash-

ing machine, delivery, installation, and a 2-year warranty, within 21 days of being assessed. For more, visit:
<https://www.water.dcccew.nsw.gov.au/our-work/projects-and-programs/water-efficiency-program/washing-machine-exchange-program>

Firearms exemptions
The NSW Nationals have welcomed the state government’s announcement that primary producers will be able to apply for more than 10 firearms.
Under questioning in Budget Estimates last week, Police Minister Yasmin Catley was asked if farmers could apply for more than ten firearms for primary production purposes.
Minister Catley clarified that, “if they have a genuine reason, as a business, or other relevant category they need one for, then they are entitled to seek an exemption.”
The NSW Nationals now look forward to holding the police minister to her commitment.

Until next time,
Dugald

Dog and puppy training classes exclusive to Wellington

WHEN YOU think about how long dogs live, having a stress free and happy coexistence is important. Being able to enjoy our time with our dogs and not worry about managing problem behaviour is important and setting up good foundations can prevent and rectify a lot of the things people have problems with.

Inspired Canine is running professional group dog training classes at Wellington on March 21 and 22 March. There is a range of group classes to suit different age groups and needs from puppies eight weeks of age right through to adult dogs.

The group environment is inclusive, non-judgmental and provides a supportive learning space for everyone. All training methods are fear free, force free techniques that apply evidence based and effective positive reinforcement methods.

The trainer has membership with the Pet Professional Guild Australia and the Australian Association of Pet Dog Trainers, which means formal qualifications have been undertaken and ongoing education is compulsory. Some people in the area are unable to access fear-free positive reinforcement training with their puppy or dog so miss out.

Everyone is unique and at different stages in their learning journey with their dog, but we all share the same destination - providing a quality and enriching life for each individual canine. That's why this intensive group class is being offered, to cater for the different needs and lifestyles of dog guardians, without the five-week commitment.

Training and socialisation are important for all dogs but especially for puppies from eight weeks and adolescent dogs. This weekend class is ideal for people who are unable to attend five weeks of puppy class to experience the benefits of group learning for their puppies and have extra personalised support in the following weeks.

The intensive classes run for two consecutive days and consist of a one-hour group class on each day, and everyone receives informative guides, attendance certificate, plus a goody bag packed with fun stuff for their canine.

Each attendee also has access to a free follow-up private consultation to be used anytime within six weeks of the course running.

Everyone will learn the recipe for success when training their dog, that can be applied to a range of situations and will be of benefit to all dog guardians no matter their level of training experience. Whether it is behaviours and tricks, from leaving objects and distractions, loose leash walking and recall, or becoming the ideal pub lunch or café companion they will gain the skills to learn a range of behaviours and strengthen the bond between human and canine.

The classes will be run at the Girl Guide Hall in Gisborne Street, which is great for people who may not know about the Guides, they can also have a sneak peek of what happens there at the hall.

The instructor was a Wellington Girl guide and absolutely loved her days attending each week and the adventures and friendships that she made, so it's exciting for her to be in the Guide Hall after all these years.

Limited private consults are also available with spots filling fast. Hopefully there will be great support from the Wellington community, and future classes can be scheduled.

See the advertisement on Page 3.

Lions shield presentation

WELLINGTON LIONS president John Pringle was honoured to accept a Progressive Shield from Past District Governor Peter Perry (pictured) at the last Lions meeting which Peter had accepted at the Lions Convention on behalf of Wellington Lions. The District Governor Judy Ryan will be attending our next meeting on March 9 to induct three new members and talk about Lions and the great work they do. All interested people who have a spare hour or two and would like to help their community are welcome to come and hear her. If you have a query or questions about Lions and our meetings phone John 0414 880 644. To celebrate Lions International birthday month of March Wellington Lions are giving away the presents! All 'Special' priced items in their preloved book shop will be half price and you can get 10 dvds or cds for only \$10! Of course most of the books are unpriced anyway which means they are only \$2. All the money raised from the bookshop is returned to the town or a charity or Lions Foundation that the members choose. The club would also like to thank all the members of the public who donate their good quality items to Lions.



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Looking back at Walmer

More on Wamer’s history researched and compiled by Neil Wykes.

The Walmer Public School

NSW EDUCATION website records that the Walmer Public School was first opened in July 1899 and closed in 1908, then reopened in 1925 and closed in December 1966.

It was called “Ganoo” until October 1904. However, articles in the Wellington Times in 1910, 1917 and 1920 refer to the Goonoo Public School but I have not found any reference to it on the NSW Education website.

It seems likely that the School was located in three different places over the period 1899 to 1966.

The first location was the Reserve where the cricket oval was located at the start of “Noonameena” Road.

The school that is referred to as opening in 1925 appears to have been located near the turn off to Arthurville where there were also Tennis Courts.

The third and final location was on land acquired from the Baird family just north of the railway crossing and opposite the other Community reserve with Tennis Courts and the Post Office in 1925.

The original location of the School

Minutes from the Walmer Famers & Settlers Association reported in the Wellington Times indicate they could not get a teacher at the end of 1908.

An article in the Wellington Times in 1906 says it was located next to a “Stock Reserve” and drovers and swagmen took the water that belonged to the school.

It seems reasonable to assume that the school was located up to 1908 and probably up to at least 1920 based on articles in the Wellington Times at the “Noonameena” turn off on the reserve where cricket was played as there was a house near the gate to Taylors property and a 1925 map says the Reserve was set aside in 1884 for the Walmer Public School.

The second Location of the School

The 1925 Map also indicates that a small parcel of land on the turn off to Arthurville was the Walmer Public School (County of Gordon, Parish of Ganoo Portion 101).

The same map also shows the land opposite the second reserve just over the railway crossing was for the Walmer Public School but we know it only moved there after a heated community debate.

This Arthurville turn off location is supported by Gordon Wykes’s recollection that our father Les had told him that it was the location of the school and his mother Frances opposed to move to the final destination.

This may account for why Frances arranged home schooling by Mr Tom Davis.

The School moved to a central location

The 1934 Map of Ganoo Parish County of Gordon shows the Walmer Public School was located on the same land as it was when I first went to primary school in 1954 aged five.

This indicates that the school moved to this location sometime after 1925 and following some heated debates.

In November 1925 The Wellington Times reported *“The Walmer Public School is again re-opened (it having been closed for several weeks, owing to the departure of the teacher in charge, Mrs. Higgins). We extend to the present teacher, Miss Jennings, a hearty welcome to our midst. Short as her stay has been with us, she has already become a general favourite with the pupils.”*

Debate

In 1928 there was a heated debate in the Wellington Times about relocating the school to its final location.

Some people wanted a more central location, and it was an argument about whether it should be on the east or west side of the railway line.

In October 1930 the Wellington Times reported *“When the new school- and residence are erected, which I am given to. understand, will .be in the near future, Walmer will begin to assume the aspect of a rural village”.*

In 1931 the Dept of Education moved the Spicers Creek school to the location on what we knew as Morley’s property.

The land was originally purchased by Lane & Sheppard and was later owned by Douglas Baird (Doug Baird married into the Lane family) who transferred it to Marie Baird when she married Harold Morley in 1950.

The central location was eventually chosen and it is just



One of the old schools. This one was destroyed by fire.

over the railway level crossing north of the Walmer railway station and across the road from the Reserve set aside for recreation of Walmer.

Teachers

From articles in the Wellington Times and other papers we have identified the following teachers in the period 1899 to 1908

* It appears the teacher in 1902 was Mr Tubman but he was affected by the heat at the start of term in 1903 and returned to Sydney



A school sports carnival.

* There is reference to Mr O Smith as the Goonoo teacher in 1903

The articles in the Wellington Times tell who the school teachers were in 1925 but I have found very little about the school teachers from 1926 to 1942.

The Wellington Times did however have some articles about the exploits of students and these are in the appendices.

Miss Jessie Pearson who was the first teacher when the school opened in January 1925 got married on 6 June 1925 so left the school on Friday 5 June 1925.

The school Picnic however did receive mention with detailed results of all the events.

See Appendices as it includes many familiar names from our childhood.

The Teachers that were known to have taught at Walmer Public School from 1925 to 1966

* 1925 – Miss Jessie Pearson to 5 June 1925, Mrs Higgins and Miss Jennings till at least 1927

* 1928 to 1942 no information found

* 1942 Sgt. Navigator Bede Darius Northmore, R.A.A.F., was killed in an aircraft accident over Scotland on 21st July 1942, and was buried at Stoneykirk, Scotland.

* 1943 to 1947 – no information

* 1947 to 1954 Mr Ernest Burrows who went to school in Lithgow

* 1955 Mrs Coterill taught at Walmer and her husband taught at Arthurville

* 1956 Mr Sykes

* 1957 Mr Archie Cottle who burnt down the school in January 1958

* 1958 to 1962 Mr Ken Forrest- He boarded in Yeoval and would catch the train to Walmer every morning then come to our place and sit by the coal fire until he got warm before walking to the school. He later married and he and his wife lived in the house that had been built on the school grounds. When he got married a house was built for the teachers to live in on the school grounds.

* 1963 to ?? Mr Hislop



A school site photographed in March 2015.

Accommodation for the Teacher

The community continually lobbied for a residence for the Teacher. One was finally built in 1960 but the school closed permanently in 1966. See the Appendices for some articles

School Picnics

The school picnic was a much anticipated and greatly enjoyed day in my childhood in the 1950’s. So, it was interesting to find that the first school picnic was held in 1899 the school’s first year and most likely every year thereafter. There are articles in the Wellington Times that give detailed results with many familiar names appearing.

The Picnic was clearly a big community day as it was followed by an evening meal and dancing and singing. At least until the ????

The Sports Carnival

The annual sports carnival was one of the highlights of the year.

It would be held at one of the local schools Arthurville, Suntop, Ponto, Curra Creek and Walmer.

A local farmer would create a 100 yard running track at the school or in a paddock, build a sand pit etc.

My time at Walmer Public School

When I attended The Walmer public school it was a one teacher school about 200 yards from the shop and on the other side of the Railway line just beyond the level crossing where the Wellington Parkes Road, now Renshaw McGirr Way, crossed the railway line from Molong to Dubbo for the last time if heading towards Wellington from Yeoval.

Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL MEMBER FOR CALARE

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- ✓ \$9.5 million for Maranatha House Aged Care
- ✓ Introduced Bill into Parliament to ban foreign buying of residential property for two years. The Coalition and the Labor Party voted against it and then they both announced it as their policy!
- ✓ Backed Independents' Bill to reduce dominance of big supermarkets. All major parties voted against it and then Coalition announced it as their policy!
- ✓ \$50 million for storm and flood recovery in the Central West
- ✓ Secured the Parliamentary Inquiry into the Disaster
- ✓ Response of Insurers \$2 billion for Great Western Highway upgrade
- ✓ \$2.02 million for replacing the Terrabella, Burrendong and Gundy Creek Bridges
- ✓ \$738,000 for the Cameron Park footbridge
- ✓ 60 mobile phone towers and base stations for Calare
- ✓ \$560,000 for Stuart Town water security project
- ✓ Secured upgrade of Wellington Hospital Emergency Department
- ✓ \$1.5 million for the intergenerational childcare facility at
- ✓ Wellington's Maranatha House
- ✓ \$1.1 million for Porto Falls Road upgrade
- ✓ \$26,700 for the Driver Reviver site at the Wellington Information Centre
- ✓ \$1.176 million for improvements at Wellington Caves
- ✓ \$1.2 million for security CCTV in Wellington and Calare communities
- ✓ \$650,000 for upgrades at Wellington Christian School
- ✓ \$200,000 for improvements at Kennard Park
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geuzie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project Stage Two
- ✓ \$50,000 for Wellington Library's outdoor reading room
- ✓ Video link for Wellington Court House

IT'S TIME TO END 'JOBS FOR THE MATES'!

In Parliament this week I supported the Transparent and Quality Public Appointments 'Jobs for the mates' Bill 2026. The Private Members Bill establishes an independent, transparent process for all major Commonwealth appointments to ensure selections are based on expertise, not political connections.

When it's 'Jobs for mates' it erodes public trust and confidence in our government and our public institutions, and making political appointments to government boards has become an accepted part of Australian political life that's been going on for far too long.

All the major parties do it when they're in government, and it's time to clean this up and bring the practice to an end. As a former minister and cabinet minister, I've seen how this process works firsthand, and it's become a time-honoured part of politics in Australia. There's nothing covert about it. But I think if the public knew the extent of it, they would be shocked, and this must change.

Trust is the truest test of whether our systems of governance are fit for purpose in both private and public settings. It's very important that we note that this bill establishes several key elements that bring openness, transparency and independence to the appointment process. It will introduce a Public Appointments Commissioner to oversee the act and set up a new



Image by AUSPIC, Department of Parliamentary Services

parliamentary joint committee on appointments to consider selections and report to the parliament on whether the committee supports the selections. This bill would also introduce a new six-month cooling-off period to prevent recent politicians or political staffers from being appointed to major public roles.

I don't think it's too much to ask that we have the most qualified people being appointed to key public positions and that there's an open, independent and transparent process around selections. If, as a nation, we are serious about restoring confidence in government, this is surely a vitally important place to start.

CALLING ON THE GOVERNMENT TO FIX THE COST-OF-LIVING CRISIS

In Parliament this week, I supported Dai Le MP, the Federal Member for Fowler, by seconding her motion on the cost of living crisis which is having devastating impacts in regional Australia and in the Calare Electorate.

Dai and I called on the government to acknowledge that Australians are still battling a cost of living crisis, with many already stretched families unable to absorb surging mortgages, rent, energy bills and everyday essentials.

Together, we called on the Government to ensure that any policies it introduces tackles the roots of cost of living, does not further exacerbate inflation rates and that it works with, and not against, the Reserve Bank's efforts to bring inflation back to target.

People living in regional Australia are among some of the hardest hit by this crisis and are facing a combination of higher prices, higher interest rates and shrinking household budgets.

A constituent contacted me recently and said:

"I'm writing because frankly I've reached my breaking point. I care for my mum while barely surviving myself. I live in fear of rent hikes that could leave me homeless. There are no mental health services for people like me – wait lists are a joke, and I've been told to 'just call Lifeline'. Last week, I chose between feeding myself or my cat – this is the reality of your government's 'cost-of-living relief. I don't want platitudes. I want a plan. It feels like no one in power cares if people like me live or die."

The cost of living is at a crisis point and regional Australia shouldn't bear the brunt. I will continue to call on the government for to take immediate effective action to ease the cost-of-living pain.

GRANTS AND FUNDING 2026

TERTIARY ACCESS PAYMENT

The Tertiary Access Payment (TAP) is a one-off payment of up to \$5,000. It's to help eligible students with the cost of moving to study. This is for study after you've finished year 12 or equivalent.

To get the payment you must move from a regional or remote area for tertiary study.

You can check if your family home is in a regional or remote area using the Student Regional Area Search.

You can still claim TAP if you get ABSTUDY, Youth Allowance or Relocation Scholarship in your first year of study.

www.servicesaustralia.gov.au/tertiary-access-payment

SUPPORTING FARMERS FACING HARDSHIP

The Federal Government has introduced a new Drought Hardship Loan designed to help with short-term operating costs as farmers face longer-term droughts.

The loan will enable farmers who have been affected by drought for at least 24 months and expect to be impacted for another season, to borrow up to \$250,000.

The loan duration will be five years, with interest incurred, but repayments fully deferred for the first two years.

To extend relief to existing RIC loan customers, interest rates on existing RIC loans will be held at 5.18% for another six months from 1 February 2026.

The new Drought Hardship Loan is delivered through the Regional Investment Corporation and you can register your interest at:

<https://www.ric.gov.au/new-loans>

FOUNDATION FOR RURAL REGIONAL RENEWAL

Strengthening Rural Communities – Prepare & Recover funding helps rural communities across Australia prevent and prepare for future climate related impacts or recover from existing disasters.

Grants up to \$25,000 are available for a broad range of initiatives to strengthen the capacity and capability of local people, organisations, networks, and systems that help communities to be informed, skilled, connected and resourced for the future.

<https://frrr.org.au/funding/src-prepare-recover/>

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THURSDAY, MARCH 5	TV 6.00 Morning Programs. 11.00 Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. Final. 11.30 QI. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Bergerac. 2.00 Parliament Question Time. 3.00 Grand Designs Transformations. Final. 4.00 Sister Boniface Mysteries. 4.45 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 Back Roads. Return. 8.30 Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. Return. 9.00 Muster Dogs. 11.00 ABC Late News. 11.15 The Business. 11.30 Late Programs.	7 6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.10 Catch Phrase. 2.00 Bridge Of Lies: Celebrity Specials. 3.00 The Chase. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6.30. 7.00 Home And Away. 7.30 Football. AFL. Opening Round. Sydney v Carlton. 10.30 AFL Post-Game Show. 11.00 Kick Ons. Return. 11.30 Australian Idol. 12.50 Dare Me. 2.00 Home Shopping. 4.00 NBC Today. 5.00 Sunrise Early News. 5.30 Sunrise.	9 6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 Married At First Sight. 1.30 Explore TV. 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Rugby League. NRL. Round 1. Melbourne Storm v Parramatta Eels. 9.55 NRL Thursday Night Footy Post-Match. 10.40 9News Late. 11.10 The Equalizer. 12.05 Tipping Point. 1.00 Surfing Australia TV. 1.30 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 2.00 Late Programs.	10 6.00 Ent. Tonight. 6.30 Bold. 7.00 Deal Or No Deal. 7.30 Farm To Fork. 8.00 Lingo. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Ent. Tonight. 10.30 Australian Survivor: Redemption. 12.00 Farm To Fork. 12.30 Family Feud. 1.00 News. 2.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 2.30 The Finish Line. 3.30 Lingo. 4.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Soccer. AFC 2026 Women's Asian Cup. Group stage. Australia v IR Iran. 10.30 10's Late News. 11.30 10 News+. 12.00 Late Programs.	SBS 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 WorldWatch. 2.00 Ancient Egypt: Top 7 Pyramids. 3.00 Going Places. 3.30 The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. 4.05 The Wonders Of Europe. 5.05 Jeopardy! 5.30 Letters And Numbers. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.35 Toronto Airport Uncovered. 8.30 The Hospital: In The Deep End. Return. 9.35 A Spy Among Friends. 10.40 SBS World News Late. 11.10 In Memoriam. 12.00 The Hollow. 2.05 Silent Road. 3.00 Late Programs.
	7two 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 South Aussie With Cost. 2.30 Air Crash Investigations. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 Medical Emergency. 4.30 Better Homes And Gardens. 5.30 Escape To The Country. 6.30 Bargain Hunt. 7.30 Father Brown. 8.30 The Inspector Lynley Mysteries. 10.30 Murdoch Mysteries. 11.30 Late Programs.	7mate 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.30 The Force: Behind The Line. 3.30 Mountain Men. 4.30 American Restoration. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.00 Football. AFL. Opening Round. Sydney v Carlton. 7.30 Highway Patrol. 8.00 Motorway Patrol. 8.30 MOVIE: Bridesmaids. (2011) 11.05 Late Programs.	7flix 6.00 It's Academic. 7.30 Beat Bugs. 8.30 Flushed. 9.00 Home Shopping. 10.00 The Great Day Out. 10.30 Farmer Wants A Wife. 12.00 9-1-1: Lone Star. 2.00 9-1-1. 3.00 Jabba's Movies. 3.30 Frogger. 4.30 The Conners. 5.30 Bondi Vet. 6.30 Judge Judy. 7.30 Ramsay's Kitchen Nightmares USA. 10.30 First Dates UK. 11.30 Late Programs.	10 drama 6.00 Home Shopping. 8.00 Days Of Our Lives. 8.45 The Young And The Restless. 9.30 JAG. 10.30 The Living Room. 11.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 JAG. 3.30 Bull. 4.30 JAG. 6.30 Bull. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 Bull. 11.15 JAG. 12.15 Home Shopping.	10 comedy 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Family Feud. 10.30 Deal Or No Deal. 11.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 11.30 Becker. 12.00 Frasier. 1.00 The Big Bang Theory. 2.00 Friends. 3.30 Becker. 4.00 Farm To Fork. 4.30 Frasier. 5.30 The Big Bang Theory. 6.30 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.
	Entertains 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.35 A Bite To Eat. 3.05 QI. 3.35 Would I Lie To You? 4.05 MythBusters. 4.55 Car S.O.S. 5.45 Portrait Artist Of The Year. 6.30 Richard Osman's House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 Tonight At The Museum. 9.00 Gruen. 9.40 Late Programs.	Family 6.00 Kids' Programs. 4.10 Andy's Safari Adventures. 4.35 Vida The Vet. 5.40 Kangaroo Beach. 6.05 PJ Masks. 6.25 The Adventures Of Paddington. 6.45 Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. 7.05 Batwheels. 7.35 Ninjago. 8.00 Deadly 60. 8.35 Secrets Of The Zoo. 9.20 Ultimate Vets. New. 9.50 Animal Park. New. 10.35 Late Programs.	NEWS 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Parliament. 3.10 ABC News Afternoons. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.30 7.30. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.45 The Business. 9.00 The World. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.30 Foreign Correspondent. 11.00 Late Programs.	Gem 6.00 Morning Programs. 11.30 My Favorite Martian. 12.00 Keeping Up Appearances. 1.00 Midsomer Murders. 3.00 Antiques Roadshow. 3.30 MOVIE: Manuela. (1957) 5.30 Yorkshire Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 RBT. 8.30 RPA. 9.30 A+E After Dark. 10.30 Forensics: The Real CSI. 11.45 Late Programs.	VICELAND 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 WorldWatch. 5.00 Alone. 6.15 The Curse Of Oak Island. 7.05 Jeopardy! 7.35 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. 8.30 MOVIE: To Catch A Killer. (2023) Shanelle Woodley. 10.40 Brassic. 12.30 Couples Therapy. 1.40 Cosplay Culture. 3.25 NHK World English News. 5.00 Late Programs.

FRIDAY, MARCH 6	TV 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Australia's Wild Odyssey. Final. 11.00 Antiques Roadshow. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 1.00 Muster Dogs. 2.00 Dog Park. 2.30 In Limbo. 2.55 Fake Or Fortune? 3.55 Murdoch Mysteries. 4.45 Long Lost Family. 5.30 Antiques Roadshow. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.35 Gardening Australia. 8.35 Professor T. 9.25 Tonight At The Museum. 9.55 The Weekly With Charlie Pickering. 10.25 Dog Park. 10.55 ABC Late News. 11.10 Murdoch Mysteries. 12.00 Late Programs.	7 6.00 Sunrise. 9.00 The Morning Show. 12.00 Seven's National News At Noon. 1.00 MOVIE: Killer Condo. (2022) 3.00 Unfiltered: Cricket. 3.30 Women's Test Cricket: Pre-Game. 4.00 Seven News At 4. 5.00 The Chase Australia. 6.00 7News Local. 6.30 7News @ 6.30. 7.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 8.00 MOVIE: Mamma Mia! (2008) Amanda Seyfried. Meryl Streep. Colin Firth. 10.20 MOVIE: Anna. (2019) Sasha Luss. 12.50 Dare Me. 2.00 Home Shopping. 4.00 Million Dollar Minute. 4.30 Late Programs.	9 6.00 Today. 9.00 Today Extra. 11.30 9News Morning. 12.00 MOVIE: Romantic Rewrite. (2022) 2.00 Pointless. 3.00 Tipping Point. 4.00 9News Afternoon. 4.30 Tipping Point Australia. 5.30 WIN News. 6.00 9News. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Rugby League. NRL. Round 1. Brisbane Broncos v Penrith Panthers. 9.55 NRL Friday Night Footy Post-Match. 10.45 MOVIE: Sicario. (2015) Emily Blunt. 1.00 Next Stop. 1.30 TV Shop: Home Shopping. 4.00 Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. 4.30 Late Programs.	10 6.00 Entertainment Tonight. 6.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 7.00 Deal Or No Deal. 7.30 Farm To Fork. 8.00 Lingo. 9.00 The Finish Line. 10.00 Australian Survivor: Redemption. 11.30 Motor Racing. Formula 1. Australian Grand Prix. Day 1. 5.00 10 News. 6.00 10 News+. 6.30 Deal Or No Deal. 7.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 7.30 Jamie Oliver: Eat Yourself Healthy. New. 8.30 Love It Or List It Australia. 9.40 10's Late News. 10.40 10 News+. 11.10 The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. 12.00 Shopping.	SBS 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 WorldWatch. 1.55 The Hospital: In The Deep End. 3.00 Nufa. 3.30 The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. 4.05 Marseille: Birth Of A Megapolis. 5.05 Jeopardy! 5.30 Letters And Numbers. 6.00 Mastermind Australia. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Going Places With Ernie Dingo. 8.30 Fukushima: Days That Shocked The World. 9.25 Fly With Me. 10.40 SBS World News Late. 11.10 Sisi. 12.05 Babylon Berlin. 2.00 El Immortal: Gangs Of Madrid. 3.50 Late Programs.
	7two 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.30 Weekend. 3.00 Australia's Best Drives. 3.30 Harry's Practice. 4.00 Women's Test. Aust v India. Arvo. 6.20 Women's Test Cricket: Tea Break. 7.00 Women's Test. Aust v India. Late arvo. 9.00 Women's Test Cricket: Dinner Break. 9.20 Women's Test. Aust v India. Evening session. 12.00 Late Programs.	7mate 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.30 Kick Ons. 3.00 Timbersports. STIHl. Timbersports. World C'ship. 3.30 American Resto. 4.00 Mountain Men. 5.00 Storage Wars. 5.30 American Pickers. 6.30 Pawn Stars. 7.00 AFL: Friday Night Countdown. 7.30 Football. AFL. Opening Round. Gold Coast Suns v Geelong. 11.00 Late Programs.	7flix 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.30 Farmer Wants A Wife. 12.00 9-1-1. 3.00 Frogger. 4.00 Lopez Vs. Lopez. 4.30 America's Got Talent: Fantasy League. 6.30 MOVIE: Paul Blart: Mall Cop. (2009) 8.30 MOVIE: Fun With Dick And Jane. (2005) Jim Carrey. Téa Leoni. Alec Baldwin. 10.20 MOVIE: Holmes & Watson. (2018) 12.20 Late Programs.	10 drama 6.00 Morning Programs. 8.45 The Young And The Restless. 9.30 JAG. 10.30 The Living Room. 11.30 The Bold And The Beautiful. 12.00 Days Of Our Lives. 12.45 The Young And The Restless. 1.30 JAG. 3.30 Bull. 4.30 Motor Racing. Formula 1. Australian Grand Prix. Day 1. 6.30 Bull. 7.30 NCIS. 10.20 Bull. 11.15 JAG. 12.15 Late Programs.	10 comedy 6.00 Morning Programs. 10.00 Family Feud. 10.30 Deal Or No Deal. 11.00 Millionaire Hot Seat. 11.30 Becker. 12.00 Frasier. 1.00 The Big Bang Theory. 2.00 Friends. 3.30 Becker. 4.00 Farm To Fork. 4.30 Frasier. 5.30 The Big Bang Theory. 6.30 Friends. 8.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.00 Becker. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 Late Programs.
	Entertains 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.45 You Can't Ask That. 3.05 QI. 3.35 Would I Lie To You? 4.05 MythBusters. 4.55 Car S.O.S. 5.45 Portrait Artist Of The Year. 6.30 Richard Osman's House Of Games. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 MOVIE: The Perfect Storm. (2000) 10.40 Late Programs.	Family 6.00 Kids' Programs. 6.05 PJ Masks. 6.25 The Adventures Of Paddington. 6.45 Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. 7.05 Gardening Australia Junior. 7.40 Star Wars: Young Jedi Adventures. 8.05 Scooby-Doo And Guess Who? 8.35 My Adventures With Superman. 8.55 BattleBots. 9.45 Gladiators UK. 10.40 Late Programs.	NEWS 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 News. 4.00 Afternoon Briefing. 5.00 ABC News With Joe O'Brien. 6.00 ABC News Hour. 7.00 ABC National News. 7.35 ABC Evening News. 8.00 ABC News Tonight. 8.35 If You're Listening. 9.00 The World. 9.30 Expense: The Nannup Four. 10.00 ABC Nightly News. 10.30 Late Programs.	Gem 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 Explore TV. 3.30 Antiques Roadshow. 4.00 MOVIE: Miss Robin Hood. (1952) 5.30 Yorkshire Auction House. 6.30 Antiques Roadshow. 7.30 Airport Security: USA. New. 8.30 MOVIE: London Has Fallen. (2016) Gerard Butler. 10.30 MOVIE: Exit Wounds. (2001) 12.30 Late Programs.	VICELAND 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.35 Where Are You Really From? 3.10 WorldWatch. 5.10 From North Korea. With Love. 6.05 Over The Black Dot. 6.35 The Future With Hannah Fry. 7.05 Jeopardy! 7.35 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. 8.30 MOVIE: Hustlers. (2019) 10.30 Cycling. UCI Track World Cup. Day 1. 12.15 Late Programs.

SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 7	TV 6.00 Rage Charts. 7.00 Weekend Breakfast. 9.00 Rage. 10.30 Rage Vault Guest Programmer. 12.00 ABC News At Noon. 12.30 Call The Midwife. 1.30 Art Detectives. Final. 2.15 All Creatures Great And Small Christmas Special. Final. 3.10 Extraordinary Escapes. 4.00 Human. Final. 5.00 Australian Story. 5.30 Dr Karl's How Things Work. 6.00 Kath & Kim. 6.30 Hard Quiz. 7.00 ABC News. 7.30 Call The Midwife. 8.30 Midsomer Murders. 10.00 This England. 11.05 Rage.	7 6.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 7.00 Weekend Sunrise. 10.00 The Morning Show: Weekend. 12.00 Horse Racing. Inglis Millennium Day And Caulfield Charity Family Day. 5.00 Seven News At 5. 5.30 Border Security: Australia's Front Line. 6.00 Seven News. 7.00 Border Security: Australia's Front Line. 7.30 MOVIE: The Mummy. (1999) Brendan Fraser. Rachel Weisz. 10.00 MOVIE: American Made. (2017) Tom Cruise. 12.20 MOVIE: Daughter In Disguise. (2021) 2.30 Late Programs.	9 6.00 Morning Programs. 8.30 Weekend Today. 11.30 Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Highlights of the Milano Cortina 2026 games. 1.00 Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026 Opening Ceremony. The Opening Ceremony of Milano Cortina 2026. Replay. 5.00 9News First At Five. 5.30 Find My Country House Australia. 6.00 9News Saturday. 7.00 A Current Affair. 7.30 Olympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 1. 12.00 Late Programs.	10 6.00 Tough Tested. 7.00 Reel Action. 7.30 Escape Fishing. 8.00 I Fish. 8.30 On The Fly. 9.00 4x4 Adventures. 10.00 I'm A Celebrity... Get Me Out Of Here! 1.00 Cook With Luke. 1.30 Frugal Foodie. 2.00 Farm To Fork. 2.30 Next Gen Dairy. New. 3.00 Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. 3.30 The Brighter Side. 4.00 Lingo. 5.00 10 News. 6.30 The Dog House Australia. 7.30 Love It Or List It Australia. Return. 8.40 Sort Your Life Out. 9.50 Ambulance Australia. 10.50 Matlock. 11.50 Late Programs.	SBS 6.00 Morning Programs. 12.00 WorldWatch. 2.00 Figure Skating. ISU Four Continents C'ships. H'lights. 4.00 Going Places With Ernie Dingo. 4.30 Cycling. Cadel Evans Great Ocean Road Race. Elite Women's. 5.30 Imperial Crown: The Myth, Mystery And Majesty. 6.30 SBS World News. 7.30 Secrets Of Britain's Historic Houses. 8.40 Swiss Alpine Rail Journeys. 9.35 The Secret DNA Of Us. 10.40 Lord Lucan. 11.45 Outlander. 2.30 Beyond Signs. 4.25 Bamay. 5.15 Euronews. 5.30 Late Programs.
	7two 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.00 Better Homes And Gardens. 4.00 Wildlife ER. 5.00 Horse Racing. Inglis Millennium Day And Caulfield Charity Family Day. 6.00 Luxury Escapes: World's Best Holidays. 6.30 Bondi Vet. Return. 7.30 The Yorkshire Vet. 8.30 Lewis. 10.30 Escape To The Country. 11.30 Late Programs.	7mate 6.00 Morning Programs. 2.00 Rides Down Under: Workshop Wars. 3.00 Motor Racing. Alpine Rally of East Gippsland. 4.00 Desert Collectors. 5.00 Counting Cars. 6.00 Pawn Stars. 7.00 Storage Wars. 7.30 MOVIE: Ghostbusters: Afterlife. (2021) 10.00 MOVIE: In The Line Of Fire. (1993) 12.40 Late Programs.	7flix 6.00 Morning Programs. 11.00 Extreme Weddings: Australia. 12.00 Blow Up. 1.00 Starstruck. 2.30 Dancing With The Stars. 4.30 Toddlers Make You Laugh Out Loud. 5.30 MOVIE: Playmobil: The Movie. (2019) 7.30 MOVIE: Maid In Manhattan. (2002) Jennifer Lopez. 9.45 MOVIE: Yesterday. (2019) Himesh Patel. 12.10 Late Programs.	10 drama 6.00 Home Shopping. 9.00 IFISH. 9.30 On The Fly. 10.30 JAG. 4.30 Soccer. A-League Men. Round 16. Brisbane Roar v Central Coast Mariners. 7.00 Football Tonight. 7.35 Soccer. A-League Men. Round 16. Western Sydney Wanderers v Melbourne City. 10.00 NCIS. 12.45 NCIS: Origins. 1.45 Home Shopping.	10 comedy 6.00 Good Chef Bad Chef. 7.00 The Bold And The Beautiful. 9.30 Millionaire Hot Seat. 10.00 Frasier. 11.00 Farm To Fork. 11.30 Deal Or No Deal. 12.00 The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. 2.00 Friends. 6.00 The Big Bang Theory. 10.30 Frasier. 11.30 The Neighborhood. 12.00 South Park. 1.00 Home Shopping. 1.30 Late Programs.
	Entertains 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.45 Documentary Now! 4.05 Would I Lie To You? 4.40 MythBusters. 5.30 Car S.O.S. 6.15 Portrait Artist Of The Year. 7.00 Spicks And Specks. 7.30 QI. 8.00 Would I Lie To You? 8.30 House Of Games. 9.00 Live At The Wireless. 10.20 Late Programs.	Family 6.00 Kids' Programs. 6.05 PJ Masks Power Heroes. 6.25 The Adventures Of Paddington. 6.50 Andy And The Band. 7.05 Phippenguins. 7.30 Hard Quiz Kids. 8.00 Chopped Junior. 8.40 Shaun Tan's Tales From Outer Suburbia. 9.25 Fresh Off The Boat. 10.10 Abbott Elementary. 10.30 Merlin. 11.15 Late Programs.	NEWS 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.30 That Pacific Sports Show. 4.00 News. 4.30 The Whillam Dismissal: 50 Years On. 5.00 News. 5.30 Asia News Week. 6.00 Evening News. 6.30 Aust Story. 7.00 National News. 7.30 Back Roads. 8.05 Four Corners. 9.00 Nightly News. 9.15 Foreign Correspondent. 10.00 Late Programs.	Gem 6.00 Morning Programs. 1.35 MOVIE: Hell Is A City. (1960) 3.25 MOVIE: Train Of Events. (1949) 5.20 MOVIE: Piccadilly Incident. (1946) 7.30 Death In Paradise. 8.40 MOVIE: Rambo: First Blood. (1982) Sylvester Stallone. Richard Crenna. 10.35 MOVIE: The Driver. (1978) 12.25 Late Programs.	VICELAND 6.00 Morning Programs. 3.05 Heroines. 3.45 WorldWatch. 5.45 Mastermind Australia. 6.45 The Food That Built The World. Return. 7.35 Engineering From Above. 8.30 Icons Unearthed: The Simpsons. 10.20 Marcella. 12.10 WWE Legends. 1.40 Dark Side Of The '90s. 2.30 NHK World English News. 5.00 Al Jazeera Newshour.

5x5

No. 381

Insert the missing letters to make 10 words – five reading across the grid and five reading down.

W		L		S
	W		I	
T		S		E
	R		E	
H		R		S

Edgeword

No. 233

Place each of the tiles of letters into the blank jigsaw below to create four six-letter words going across and down.

MU	AR
SE	TT
ER	IM
PO	NE

There may be more than one possible answer.

Crossmath

No. 231

Insert each number from 1 to 9 in the shaded squares to solve all the horizontal and vertical equations. Multiplication and division are performed before addition and subtraction.

	-		+		=	11
x		+		-		
	+		+		=	17
+		x		÷		
	x		x		=	96
=		=		=		
18		37		5		

Solutions

5	37	18				
=	=	=				
8	x	4	x	3	=	96
2	+	9	+	6	=	17
5	-	1	+	7	=	11

Crossmath

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**TV**

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** Offsiders. **10.30** The World This Week. **11.00** Compass. **11.30** Songs Of Praise. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **12.30** Landline. **1.30** Gardening Australia. **2.30** Muster Dogs. **3.30** The Piano UK. **4.30** Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. **5.00** Back Roads. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Compass. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** Muster Dogs. Final. **8.30** Dog Park. Final. **9.00** This England. Final. **10.05** Blue Murder Motel. **10.55** Top End Bub. **11.20** MOVIE: Partisan. (2015) **1.00** Late Programs.

**7two**

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.30** Harry's Practice. **3.00** The Amazing Homemakers. **4.00** The Yorkshire Vet. **5.00** Secrets Of Beautiful Gardens. **6.00** Escape To The Country. **7.00** Women's Test. Aust v India. Late arvo. **9.00** Women's Test Cricket: Dinner Break. **9.20** Women's Test. Aust v India. Evening session. **12.00** Late Programs.

**Entertains**

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** ER. **3.00** Not Going Out. **3.30** QI. **4.05** Would I Lie To You? **4.35** MythBusters. **5.25** Car S.O.S. **6.15** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** The Piano UK. Final. **9.30** Muster Dogs. Final. **10.30** ER. **11.15** Offsiders. **11.45** Late Programs.

**7**

6.00 NBC Today. **7.00** Weekend Sunrise. **10.00** The Morning Show: Weekend. **12.00** Sunday Footy Feast. Return. **2.30** Jabba's Movies. **3.00** Surf Patrol. **3.30** Better Homes And Gardens Summer. **4.30** Border Security: Australia's Front Line. **5.00** Seven News At 5. **5.30** Sydney Weekender. **6.00** Seven News. **7.00** The 1% Club UK. **8.00** Billy Joel Live At Madison Square Garden. **10.00** The Hunters. **11.30** Border Security: International. **12.00** Late Programs.

**7mate**

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** Red's Fishing Adventures. **2.30** Hook, Line And Sink. **3.00** Pawn Stars. **4.00** Cricket. Women's Test. Aust v India. Arvo. **6.20** Women's Test Cricket: Tea Break. **7.00** Football. AFL. Opening Round. St Kilda v Collingwood. **10.30** AFL Post-Game Show. **11.00** Late Programs.

**Family**

6.00 Kids' Programs. **4.20** Dino Dex. **4.45** Gardening Australia Junior. **5.10** Isadora Moon. **5.40** Super Monsters. **6.05** Knee High Spies. **6.25** The Adventures Of Paddington. **7.05** Let's Go Bananas! **7.30** The Investigators. **8.00** Meet The Hedgehogs. **8.45** Amazing Animal Friends. **9.35** Fresh Off The Boat. **10.15** Merlin. **11.00** Late Programs.

**9**

6.00 Hello SA. **6.30** A Current Affair. **7.00** Weekend Today. **10.00** Wide World Of Sports. **11.00** NRL. Sunday Footy Show. Return. **1.00** Paralympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 1. **2.00** David Attenborough's Dynasties II. **3.00** Rugby League. NRL. Round 1. Dolphins v South Sydney Rabbitohs. **6.00** 9News Sunday. **7.00** Married At First Sight. **8.45** 60 Minutes. **9.45** 9News Late. **10.15** Hunting Bundy: Chase For The Devil. **11.15** The First 48. **12.05** Wild Cards. **1.00** Late Programs.

**7flix**

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** Home And Away. **2.00** America's Got Talent: Fantasy League. **4.00** Gold Coast Ocean Rescue. **5.00** A Year On Planet Earth. **6.00** Puppy School. **6.30** Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly. **7.30** Law & Order: Criminal Intent. **8.30** Law & Order: SVU. **10.30** Bones. **11.30** Late Programs.

**NEWS**

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** News. **2.15** Playing On A Prayer. **3.00** News. **3.30** Offsiders. **4.00** Landline. **5.00** ABC News With Austan. **5.30** News Regional. **6.00** Evening News. **6.30** Foreign Correspondent. **7.00** National News. **7.30** Insiders. **8.35** If You're Listening. **9.00** ABC Nightly News. **9.30** Finding Stars. **10.00** Late Programs.

**10**

6.00 Mass For You At Home. **6.30** Key Of David. **7.00** Joseph Prince: New Creation Church. **7.30** My Market Kitchen. **8.00** Farm To Fork. **8.30** Motor Racing. Formula 1. Australian Grand Prix. Day 3. **5.00** 10 News. **6.30** 10 News+. **7.00** Soccer. AFC 2026 Women's Asian Cup. Group stage. Australia v Korea Republic. **10.30** Gold Wars Downunder. New. **11.30** MOVIE: The Lost City. (2022) Sandra Bullock. **1.45** 10 News+. **2.10** Law & Order: SVU. **3.00** Home Shopping.

**drama**

6.00 Home Shopping. **8.00** Tough Tested. **9.00** What's Up Down Under. **9.30** Reel Action. **10.00** JAG. **11.00** Mixed Martial Arts. UFC 326. Prelims. **1.00** Top Gear Australia. **2.30** JAG. **7.30** NCIS. **10.20** Matlock. **11.15** JAG. **12.15** Home Shopping.

**Gem**

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** Getaway. **2.30** Traffic Cops. **3.30** MOVIE: San Demetrio, London. (1943) **5.30** Midsomer Murders. **7.30** David Attenborough's Planet Earth III. **8.40** Paramedics. **9.40** Emergency. **10.40** Paralympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 1. Replay. **11.40** Late Programs.

**SBS**

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** Cycling. ProVelo Super League. Harbour City GP. **4.00** PBS News Compass Points. **4.30** WorldWatch. **5.00** Rehabilitating. **5.30** Women Of WWII: The Untold Stories. New. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Pompeii: Life In The City With Dan Snow. New. **9.15** Ancient Empires. **10.55** Roberta Flack. **12.25** Jackie And Lee: A Tale Of Two Sisters. **1.20** Cycling. UCI World Tour. Paris-Nice Race. Stage 1. **3.20** Mastermind Australia. **4.20** Bamay. **5.00** Late Programs.

**comedy**

6.00 Good Chef Bad Chef. **7.00** Deal Or No Deal. **9.30** The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. **2.30** Friends. **6.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.30** Ridiculousness. **12.00** Home Shopping.

**VICELAND**

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.30** Heroines. **3.00** Making Waves: Extraordinary Women. **3.30** WorldWatch. **4.30** PBS News Compass Points. **5.30** Smoke And Steel: Secrets Of The Modern World. **6.05** The Architecture The Railways Built. **7.00** Cycling. UCI Track World Cup. **10.55** Late Programs.

**TV**

6.00 Morning Programs. **11.30** Back Roads. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** Landline. **2.00** Spicks And Specks. **2.30** Anh's Brush With Fame. **3.00** Fake Or Fortune? **3.55** Murdoch Mysteries. **4.45** Long Lost Family. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Australian Story. **8.30** ABC National Forum. New. **9.35** Media Watch. **9.50** Planet America. **10.20** Foreign Correspondent. **10.55** ABC Late News. **11.10** The Business. **11.25** Late Programs.

**7two**

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.00** Australia: The Story Of Us. **2.00** Weekender. **2.30** This Rugged Coast. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Medical Emergency. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** Doc Martin. **8.30** A Touch Of Frost. **10.50** Ambulance: Code Red. **11.50** Late Programs.

**Entertains**

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.05** QI. **3.35** Would I Lie To You? **4.05** MythBusters. **5.00** Car S.O.S. **5.45** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **6.30** Richard Osman's House Of Games. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Penn & Teller: Fool Us. **9.35** Elementary. **10.20** Late Programs.

**7**

6.00 Sunrise. **9.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** Seven's National News At Noon. **1.10** Blankety Blank. **2.00** Bridge Of Lies. **3.00** The Chase. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6.30. **7.00** Home And Away. **7.30** Australian Idol. **9.10** The Agenda Setters. Rugby League. New. **10.10** The Agenda Setters. Return. **11.10** To Be Advised. **12.10** Conviction. **1.10** Travel Oz. **2.00** Home Shopping. **4.00** NBC Today. **5.00** Sunrise Early News. **5.30** Sunrise.

**7mate**

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.30** Supercars C'ship. Melbourne Supersprint. Hlights. **4.00** Women's Test. Aust v India. Arvo. **6.20** Women's Test Cricket: Tea Break. **7.00** Women's Test. Aust v India. Late arvo. **9.00** Women's Test Cricket: Dinner Break. **9.20** Women's Test. Aust v India. Evening session. **12.00** Late Programs.

**Family**

6.00 Kids' Programs. **4.15** Andy's Safari Adventures. **4.40** Vida The Vet. **5.20** Millie Magnificent. **6.05** PJ Masks. **6.25** The Adventures Of Paddington. **6.45** Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. **7.05** Batwheels. **7.35** Ninjago. **8.00** Deadly 60. **8.35** Gladiators UK. **9.35** Kids BBQ Championship. **10.15** Merlin. **11.00** Late Programs.

**9**

6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** Married At First Sight. **1.30** Paralympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 2. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** Married At First Sight. **9.00** 100% Footy. Return. **10.00** 9News Late. **10.30** Outback Opal Hunters. **11.30** Sight Unseen. **12.30** Footy Classified. Return. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.30** Global Shop. **3.00** Late Programs.

**7flix**

6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** The Great Day Out. **10.30** Farmer Wants A Wife. **12.00** My France With Maria. **1.00** Anh Does Vietnam. **3.00** Australian Idol. **4.30** The Conners. **5.30** Bondi Vet. **6.30** Judge Judy. **7.30** Law & Order. **8.30** Law & Order: Criminal Intent. **9.30** Law & Order: SVU. **10.30** Bones. **11.30** Late Programs.

**NEWS**

6.00 Morning Programs. **3.00** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** Afternoon Briefing. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.45** The Business. **9.00** The World. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.30** Planet America. **11.00** ABC Late News. **11.30** Late Programs.

**10**

6.00 Ent. Tonight. **6.30** Bold. **7.00** Deal Or No Deal. **7.30** Farm To Fork. **8.00** Lingo. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Ent. Tonight. **10.30** Australian Survivor: Redemption. **12.00** Farm To Fork. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** News. **2.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **2.30** The Finish Line. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **7.30** Australian Survivor: Redemption. **9.00** Matlock. **10.00** 10's Late News. **11.00** 10 News+. **11.30** Late Programs.

**drama**

6.00 Home Shopping. **8.00** Days Of Our Lives. **8.45** The Young And The Restless. **9.30** The Living Room. **11.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** JAG. **3.30** Bull. **4.30** JAG. **6.30** Bull. **7.30** NCIS. **10.20** Bull. **11.15** JAG. **12.15** Home Shopping.

**Gem**

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.10** Shakespeare And Hathaway. **3.10** Antiques Roadshow. **3.40** MOVIE: The Duke Wore Jeans. (1958) **5.30** Yorkshire Auction House. **6.30** Antiques Roadshow. Return. **7.30** Death In Paradise. **8.40** The Brokenwood Mysteries. **10.40** Paralympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 2. Replay. **12.10** Late Programs.

**SBS**

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.10** WorldWatch. **1.00** PBS News Compass Points. **1.30** WorldWatch. **2.00** Irish Road Trip With Miriam Margolyes. **3.00** Going Places. **3.30** The Cook Up. **4.05** Vietnam: The Birth Of A Nation. New. **5.05** Jeopardy! **5.30** Letters And Numbers. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Inside The Tower Of London. Return. **8.30** 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. **9.25** Never Mind The Buzzcocks. **10.05** SBS World News Late. **10.35** Late Programs.

**comedy**

6.00 Morning Programs. **11.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **11.30** Becker. **12.00** Frasier. **1.00** The Big Bang Theory. **2.00** Friends. **3.30** Becker. **4.00** Farm To Fork. **4.30** Ultimate Classroom. **5.00** Frasier. **5.30** The Big Bang Theory. **6.30** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.00** Becker. **10.30** Frasier. **11.30** Late Programs.

**VICELAND**

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.05** Over The Black Dot. **2.35** Stories From The Cities. **3.05** WorldWatch. **4.00** PBS News Compass Points. **4.30** WorldWatch. **5.00** Alone. **6.15** The Curse Of Oak Island. **7.05** Jeopardy! **7.35** 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. **8.30** MOVIE: The Count Of Monte Cristo. (2002) **11.05** Late Programs.

**TV**

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** Death In Paradise. **2.00** Parliament Question Time. **3.00** Fake Or Fortune? **4.00** Murdoch Mysteries. **4.45** Long Lost Family. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Foreign Correspondent. **8.30** Todd Sampson's Why? **9.00** If You're Listening: Black Swans. **9.35** Creative Types With Virginia Trioli. **10.05** Compass. **10.35** ABC Late News. **10.50** The Business. **11.05** ABC National Forum. **12.05** Late Programs.

**7two**

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.30** Home In WA. **2.00** Creek To Coast. **2.30** Escape To The Country. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Medical Emergency. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** Call The Midwife. **8.45** Judge John Deed. **10.45** Northern Lights. **11.45** Late Programs.

**Entertains**

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.35** A Bite To Eat. **3.05** QI. **3.35** Would I Lie To You? **4.05** MythBusters. **4.55** Car S.O.S. **5.40** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **6.30** Richard Osman's House Of Games. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Fisk. **9.00** Dog Park. **9.35** Elementary. **10.15** Late Programs.

**7**

6.00 Sunrise. **9.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** Seven's National News At Noon. **1.10** Blankety Blank. **2.00** Bridge Of Lies. **3.00** The Chase. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6.30. **7.00** Home And Away. **7.30** Australian Idol. **9.10** Doc. **10.10** Ambulance: Code Red. **11.10** The Agenda Setters. **12.10** Dirty John. New. **2.30** Home Shopping. **4.00** NBC Today. **5.00** Sunrise Early News. **5.30** Sunrise.

**7mate**

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.30** Pawn Stars. **1.30** Outback Opal Hunters. **3.30** Mountain Men. **4.30** American Restoration. **5.00** Storage Wars. **5.30** American Pickers. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.30** Outback Truckers. **8.30** Cape Carnage: Killer Catch. New. **9.30** Outback Truckers. **10.30** Railroad Australia. **11.30** Late Programs.

**Family**

6.00 Kids' Programs. **5.20** Millie Magnificent. **6.05** PJ Masks. **6.25** The Adventures Of Paddington. **6.45** Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. **7.05** Batwheels. **7.35** Ninjago. **8.00** Deadly 60. **8.35** Steve Backshall Vs The Vertical Mile. **9.25** Meet The Hedgehogs. **10.30** Merlin. **10.55** Late Programs.

**9**

6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** Married At First Sight. **1.30** Paralympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 3. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** Married At First Sight. **9.00** The Hunting Wives. **10.30** 9News Late. **10.40** Wild Cards. **11.35** Next Stop. **12.05** Tipping Point. **1.00** Destination WA. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.30** Our State On A Plate. **3.00** Late Programs.

**7flix**

6.00 It's Academic. **7.30** Kitty Is Not A Cat. **8.30** Flushed. **9.00** Home Shopping. **10.00** The Great Day Out. **10.30** Farmer Wants A Wife. **12.00** 9-1-1. **3.00** Australian Idol. **4.30** The Conners. **5.30** Bondi Vet. **6.30** Judge Judy. **7.30** CSI: New York. **8.30** CSI: Crime Scene Investigation. **9.30** CSI: Miami. **10.30** CSI: New York. **11.30** Late Programs.

**NEWS**

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** Parliament. **3.10** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** Afternoon Briefing. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.45** The Business. **9.00** The World. **10.00** ABC National Forum. **11.00** ABC Late News. **11.30** Late Programs.

**10**

6.00 Morning Programs. **8.00** Lingo. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Ent. Tonight. **10.30** Australian Survivor: Redemption. **12.00** Farm To Fork. Final. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** News. **2.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **2.30** The Finish Line. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **7.30** Australian Survivor: Redemption. **8.40** NCIS. **9.40** 10's Late News. **10.40** 10 News+. **11.10** The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. **12.00** Late Programs.

**drama**

6.00 Home Shopping. **8.00** Days Of Our Lives. **8.45** The Young And The Restless. **9.30** JAG. **10.30** The Living Room. **11.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** JAG. **3.30** Bull. **4.30** JAG. **6.30** Bull. **7.30** NCIS. **8.30** Fire Country. **9.25** NCIS. **10.20** Bull. **11.15** JAG. **12.15** Home Shopping.

**Gem**

6.00 Morning Programs. **1.00** The Brokenwood Mysteries. **3.10** Antiques Roadshow. **3.40** MOVIE: Two Way Stretch. (1960) **5.30** Yorkshire Auction House. **6.30** Antiques Roadshow. **7.30** New Tricks. **8.40** Agatha Christie's Marple. **10.40** Paralympic Winter Games Milano Cortina 2026. Day 3. Replay. **12.10** Late Programs.

**SBS**

6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** WorldWatch. **2.00** Irish Road Trip With Miriam Margolyes. **3.00** Trail Towns. **3.35** The Cook Up. **4.05** Vietnam: The Birth Of A Nation. **5.05** Jeopardy! **5.30** Letters And Numbers. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Great Continental Railway Journeys. **8.30** Insight. **9.30** Dateline. **10.00** Rock Legends. **10.30** SBS World News Late. **11.00** Exit. **11.55** The Carnival. **1.10** Cycling. UCI World Tour. Paris-Nice Race. Stage 3. **3.15** Late Programs.

**comedy**

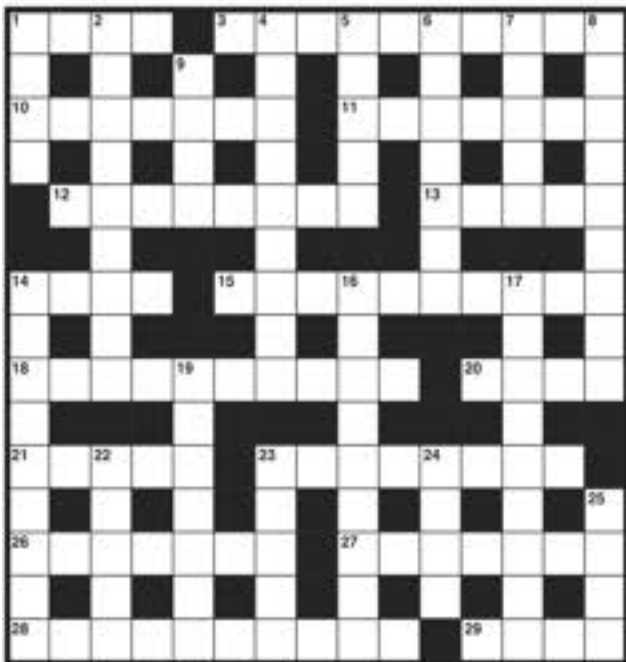
6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** Family Feud. **10.30** Deal Or No Deal. **11.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **11.30** Becker. **12.00** Frasier. **1.00** The Big Bang Theory. **2.00** Friends. **3.30** Becker. **4.00** Farm To Fork. **4.30** Frasier. **5.30** The Big Bang Theory. **6.30** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **10.00** Becker. **10.30** Frasier. **11.30** Late Programs.

**VICELAND**

6.00 Morning Programs. **2.35** Kars & Stars. **3.05** WorldWatch. **5.00** Alone. **6.15** The Curse Of Oak Island. **7.05** Jeopardy! **7.35</**

CROSSWORD

No. 166



- 26 Queen of the fairies (7)
27 Ago (7)
28 Chutzpah (10)
29 Ornamental quartz (4)
- DOWN**
1 Absent (4)
2 Banishment (9)
4 Unable to pay (9)
5 Scottish child (5)
6 Tyro (7)
7 Infant (5)
8 Fizzles out (4,5)
9 Small body of water (4)
14 Christmas plant (9)
16 Underclothes (9)
17 From Oslo, e.g. (9)
19 Attack (3,4)
22 Theme (5)
23 Dark complexion (arch) (5)
24 Pig meat (4)
25 French for prize (4)

ACROSS

- 1 Perched (4)
3 Devilish (10)
10 Creates (7)
11 Sloping type (7)
12 Instrument in the lute family (8)
13 Points in a network (5)
14 Central (4)
15 Repeated happening (10)
18 Likeness (10)
20 Stiffly neat (4)
21 Uneven (5)
23 Shell fragments (8)

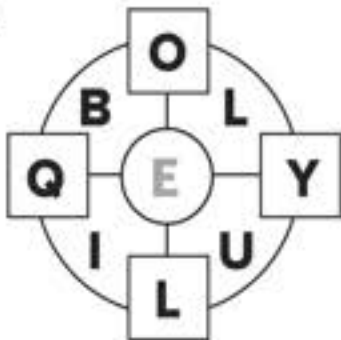


9-LETTER

No. 166

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".

Today's Aim:
7 words: Good
10 words: Very good
14 words: Excellent

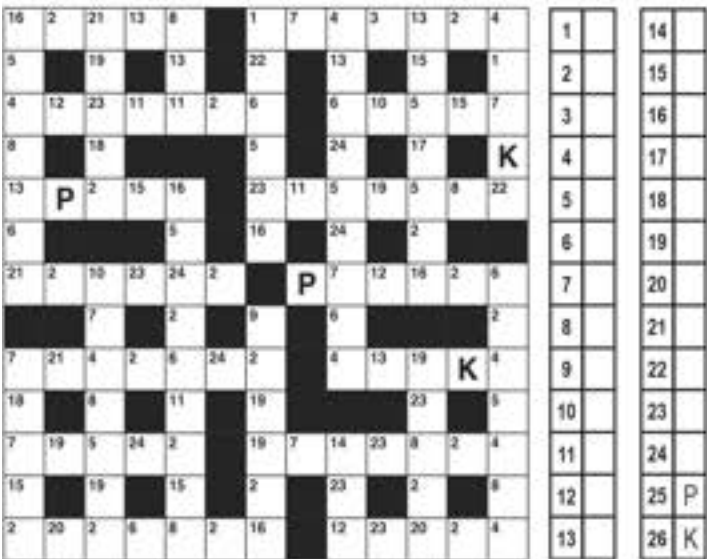


bel, belly, bile, blue,
bole, bow, robe, tobul,
obey, oblique,
oblique, quell,
yell, yule

CODEWORD

No. 116

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?



SOLUTIONS: 1=M, 2=E, 3=Q, 4=A, 5=L, 6=B, 7=R, 8=T, 9=I, 10=G, 11=V, 12=W, 13=U, 14=M, 15=C, 16=N, 17=O, 18=F, 19=Z, 20=L, 21=X, 22=Y, 23=A, 24=V

QUICK QUIZ

- Which former Neighbours actor starred in Martin Scorsese's The Wolf of Wall Street (2013)?
- To defenestrate someone is to do what to them?
- Allurophobia is a fear of what domesticated animal?
- What was the office held by Sir William Cairns, after whom the city was named?
- In the arts, the Baroque period started around the beginning of which century?
- What is the pigment carmine derived from?
- Built of bluestone and sarsen, what is arguably the world's most famous Neolithic monument?
- A calamondin is a cross between which two fruits?
- Which Beatles album was released in December 1965?
- Gwyneth Paltrow (pictured) plays the role of Margot in which 2001 Wes Anderson film?



ANSWERS: 1. Margot Robbie 2. Throw them out the window 3. Cats 4. State governor 5. 17th 6. Crushed up insects 7. Stonehenge 8. Mordant and kumquat 9. Rubber Soul 10. The Royal Tenenbaums

WORDFIT

No. 076

3 LETTERS

AMP
DNA
EEL
EMU
FAD
GEE
GET
GIT
HUN
IMP
LAS
NON
OUR
PAD
RED
ROO
RUN
SAC
SET
TAR
THE
VAN
WAN
WAR

STET
STIR
TERM

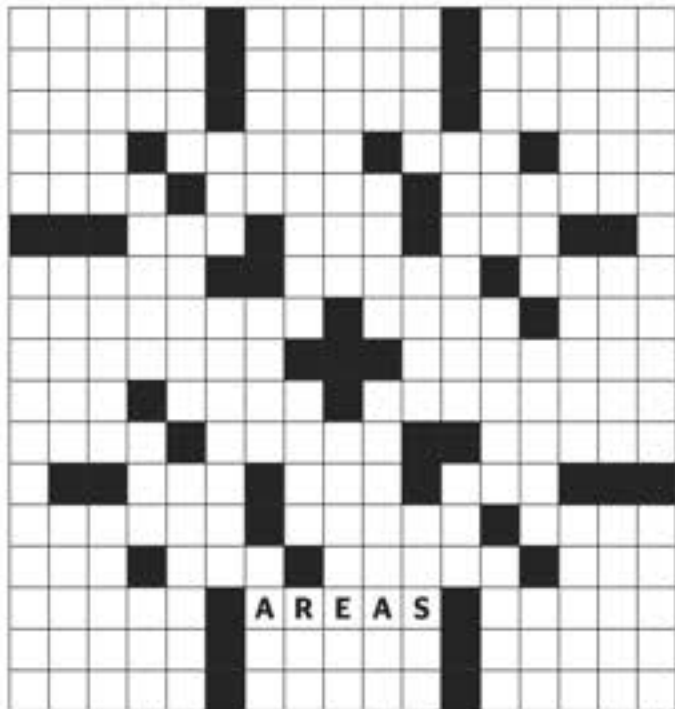
5 LETTERS

ABASE
ACUTE
ADDER
AFIRE
AIDES
ALIVE
ANELE
AREAS
ARISE
ASIDE
BERET
BLADE
BLUSH
CARAT
EGEST
ELATE
ENEMA
ENTER
ERICA
EUROS
FORGE
HOUSE
INERT
INNER
INTER
LINER
MARGE
MEETS
MENUS
NASAL
OVERT
PASTA
RECUR

4 LETTERS

BEDS
ERIN
HIFI
HREF
NASA
PLEA
RHEA
RIGA
ROME
SCAB
STEP

7 LETTERS
ADDED UP
CREATOR
OILSEED
ROTUNDA
RUPTURE
UNUSUAL

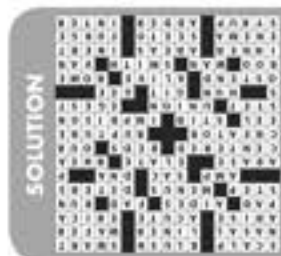


SCALP
SEETO
SMITH
SNAPS
SONNY
SPREE
SWART
SYRUP
TIGER
TONER
UNION
VISOR
WAFER

6 LETTERS
DETERS
OSTEND
SWEDEN
UNWRAP

8 LETTERS
CENTERED
IMPRISON
INTIMATE
LICENSED

11 LETTERS
ACCESSORIES
TRANSPARENT



SUDOKU

No. 166

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns; each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.



SOLUTIONS



WORD SEARCH

No. 076



Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.

- | | | |
|-------------|-------------|------------|
| APHID | LACEWING | SCARAB |
| BEDBUG | LADYBUG | SILKWORM |
| BEETLE | LARVA | STINK BUG |
| CATERPILLAR | LICE | TERMITE |
| CHRYSLIS | LOCUST | TSETSE FLY |
| CICADA | LOUSE | WASP |
| EARWIG | MAGGOT | WEEVIL |
| FIRE ANT | MANTIS | |
| FLEA | MEADOW-HAWK | |
| GNAT | MIDGE | |
| GRUB | MONARCH | |
| HORNET | MOTH | |
| HORSE FLY | ROACH | |
| HOUSE FLY | | |

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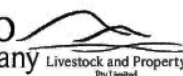
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Yet another dry week for most of us, just high humidity. Still no rain for next seven days, just overcast weather. Now we are officially in autumn, I believe we will experience an Indian summer.

ANZ AGRI in focus

Extracts autumn 2026 Commodity Insights.. Let’s start with beef. China has introduced new beef import quotas with a 55% tariff on out of quota imports effective January 1, 2026. These measures are aimed at supporting China’s self-sufficiency targets, which include achieving 85% self-sufficiency in beef and mutton by 2026 compared with current levels of around 68%.

The domestic Chinese beef herd has been in long term decline and is expected to decline again this year to levels not seen since 2011 - the second lowest since 1989. China is looking to slow the rise in beef consumption, which has jumped 70% in just 10 years, following the impact of African swine fever. China’s beef imports are Brazil 46.6%, Argentina 20.7%, Uruguay 8.5%, Australia 7.5%, NZ 5.2%, USA 4.8%.

Grains and oilseeds.. Australia has delivered a bumper crop, with 2025/2026 grains, oilseeds and pulses production around 70.7million tonnes, the second highest on record.

Wheat, barley and canola account for around 58.5 million tonnes, with strong volumes coinciding with softer prices as global production remains high. WA recorded a particularly strong season, while eastern states outcomes were more variable due to rainfall timing.

Globally, wheat, barley and canola production remains high across all major exporters, intensifying competition. As a result, export outcomes in 2026 are likely to be shaped less by production and more by currency, logistics, freight and market access. **to be continued.**

Markets at a Glance

WOOL.. The largest offering (50,701 bales) for three years had the EMI close 1716c/kg clean, a rise of 23cents. Sydney Merino f1c fine, attracted premiums on day 1 day2. Bulky locks and crutchings lifted with some Merino locks rising up to 100c, skirtings, VM underpinning price 10to 20c rises on day2. XB fault free rose on day 2 NRI 1752c/kg clean (up 15c), pass in-rate Sydney 5.2% with 676 bales withdrawn.

CATTLE.. CTLX 24th. 2440 cattle, down 1220. Quality good, large supplies of light cattle suitable for restockers and feeders. Young trade cattle 45 to 20c dearer, Prime yearling steers 468c to 475c, heifers 430c to 449c/kg. Feeder steers lifted 15c, 435c to 546c, heifers gained 10c, 410c to 463c/kg. Light steers to restockers reached 544c, heifers to 452c/kg. Grown cattle 20c to 30c dearer, heavy steers 430c to 470c, heifers 420c to 458c/kg. Light steers to restockers reached 544c, heifers to 452c/kg. Grown cattle 20c to 30c dearer, heavy steers 430c to 470c, heifers 420c to 458c/kg. Cows 5c better, 2 & 3 scores 344c to 386c, heavy cows, 374c to 394c/kg. Heavy bulls to 413c/kg.

SHEEP.. CTLX 25th. 2430 (-927) sheep, 4320(-2691) lamb. Quality good, trade and heavy lambs well supplied. [Less lighter secondary lambs suit restockers. Market dearer. Trade weights 20kg to 24 kg lifted \$10 -plus, \$236 to \$273, ave 1100 c to 1150c/kg cwt. Heavy 24kg \$15 to \$20 dearer, \$276 to \$340, ave 1090c/kg cwt. Light lambs to restockers to \$233, heavy hoggets to \$250.

MUTTON.. 2430 mixed quality, prices strong. Merino ewes \$122 to \$192, xb ewes \$142 to \$309. Merino wethers \$170 to \$249, heavy xb rams to \$160.



**Plasto
& Company** Livestock and Property

Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE yarded 4400. Good numbers of prime cattle in all sections. All regular buyers operating, and a southern trade processor. Young trade cattle 10c dearer, yearlings 412c to 478c/kg. Feeder steers and heifers up to 15c dearer, steers 432c to 513c/kg, heifers 400c to 470c/kg. Young restocker cattle very strong competition, steers to 552c, heifers to 452c/kg. Grown steers and heifers 15c dearer, steers 423c to 482c/kg, heifers 410c to 484c/kg. Cows 10c to 15c dearer, 2 and 3-scores to processors 310c to 388c/kg. Prime heavy cows 372c to 414c, ave 395c/kg. Cows to restockers 234c to 340c/kg. Heavy bulls to 410c/kg.

DUBBO LAMB yarded 19,220. Big numbers of light lambs and secondary trade weights. Dorpers best represented trade lambs, limited heavy and extra heavy lambs. Restockers filled void in light export orders. Market sold firm to dearer. Light restocker lambs lifted \$20 to \$30 – less competition from trade. Prices \$70 to \$188. Best of trade lambs to paddocks \$264./. Trade lambs \$9 dearer, \$208 to \$266, ave 1050c to 1100c/kg cwt. Heavy lambs firm, \$258 to \$324, ave 1050 and 1100c/kg. Extra heavy reached an impressive \$477. Heavy hoggets \$15 cheaper with less finish through the heavy weights and reached \$280/head.

MUTTON.. Numbers eased and the

*Around the tracks
with Col Hodges*

Racing at Yass

ALTHOUGH SHE only occasionally has race rides, Rebecca McRae on her home track, won the first three races at Yass Picnics on Saturday, with two of the winners, Rogue Hero and Texas Open, being trained by her husband Alan McRae.

The other winner on the biggest day of Rebecca’s career was Memphis Tennessee from the John Rolfe stable at Canberra.

Reared in the Tottenham area and a long time trainer at Yass, Alan McRae had Rogue Hero primed for a good run first-up and the \$2 equal favourite tracked the leader before winning the 900 metres Commence Communications Maiden Plate by a length from Air Miles (Leandro Ribeiro, \$2) and Guetary (Paul Zerafa, \$4).

Giving Alan and Rebecca McRae the second leg of a family double, Texas Open (\$3.20 equ fav) kicked clear turning for home and at the finish had over two lengths to spare from Callie Cool (Leandro Ribeiro, \$3.20) and Mihrimah (Ricky Blewitt, \$4.20) in the 900m Yarrah/Waldren Constructions Class 3 Handicap.

With her confidence buoyed, Rebecca McRae, cheered on by the big crowd, then led all the way on the John Rolfe trained Memphis Tennessee (\$4.40) to beat Kuroshinzo (Leandro Ribeiro, \$4) and Mary Le Bone (Ricky Blewitt, \$3.20 fav) in the 1200m Michael Abbey Memorial Class B Handicap.

Denis Consadine ventured from Mudgee as the trainer of I Alone to land a winner at Yass in the 1350m Endeavor Meats/Pickles Ag Maiden Plate.

Patently ridden by Narromine jockey Ricky Blewitt, I Alone (\$2.50) came from last and after a good battle with Nineteenth Hole (Zara Lewis, \$2.70) beat that horse in a close finish while Romantic Tom (Leandro Ribeiro, \$4.40) was over four lengths back in third place.

Setting a weight carrying record, the Todd Smart, Canberra trained Gundy Guy humped 77.5kg to a runaway win in the 1350m Elders Yass/EJ Merriman Ravensworth Yass Picnic Cup.

Travelling third behind Luna Angel and Foxwell, Gundy Guy (Dylan Parrott, \$2 fav) in an incredible performance under the massive weight cleared out to win by over four lengths from Allande (Leandro Ribeiro, \$4.40) and Foxwell (Ricky Blewitt, \$13).

Dylan Parrott completed a double when he brought the Warren Ganderton, Nowra trained Human Shield (\$2.90 fav) from behind the leaders to beat I’m Kenough (Leandro Ribeiro, \$4.40) and Individualist (Amber Collins, \$10) in the 1100m Nimbus Finance Brokers Trophy Handicap.

Meetings to follow Orange today, Dubbo tomorrow (Friday), Tottenham Picnics Saturday and Cowra on Monday with the Western Racing Association - \$150,000 Evergreen Turf Country Championship Qualifier scheduled for Sunday, March 15 at Coonamble.



Dubbo (02) 6885 0549



Wellington 0427 919 062

WEEKLY MARKET REPORT
Week ending February 27, 2026
AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

AWEX INDEX	This Week \$15/25	This Week M15/25	Last Sale \$15/25	Sydney Change	Last Sale Sydney	Sydney Weekly Change
E1	2325	2298	2298	+28	2308	+618
E8	2240	2231	2231	+9	2267	+674
E9	2112	2131	2091	+20	2486	+626
E6	2029	2048	2029	+1	1440	+587
E3	2004	2015	-	-	-	-
E5	895	895	-	-	-	-
E8	732	705	729	3	415	+905
MIC	768	768	896	+72	726	+342

Market best for more than two years

WITH THE largest offering since January 2023, this week’s wool market continued to strengthen, particularly the fine to medium Merino types. The jury was out on what the sentiment would be after the inaugural Chinese New Year recess, with much said about the build-up in volume of the offering and what impact that would have on prices. The result defied expectations of most, with up to 43 cent gains in the offering of 50,701 bales. Most of the gains in the North were on the first day, whilst Fremantle had a better result on Wednesday. Melbourne had their first three-day sale in ten months, and strengthened as the days progressed. The skirtings ended without much change, as did the crossbreds, with the star performer being the cardings, lifting an average of 70 cents across the three selling centres.

Exporters reflected on the dramatic change in confidence that is being expressed by top makers over the

past three months, and the change in value that has been realised. Financial facilities have been well and truly stretched all along the pipeline, however the corner might have been turned and credit is starting to free up. When you look at the EMI in US dollar terms, you can see why it has been a struggle to keep finance rolling, with a massive 61.9% increase on the same time as last year. In industry news, AWI has announced Bryan Fry as the new CEO, who most recently served as Chairman and global CEO of Pernod Ricard Winemakers, where he led large scale international operations across multiple markets. His career is highlighted by a combination of hands-on agricultural experience as an agronomist, brand development, marketing and commercial strategy, which makes him well suited to lead AWI. Macwool and Carmichael catalogued 924 bales offered on Tuesday, in a national total of 38,246 bales over the three selling centres.

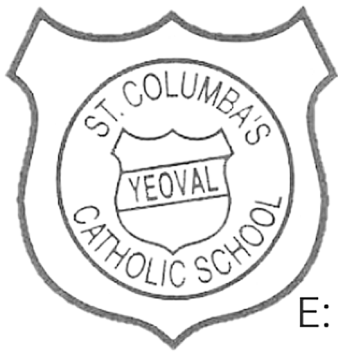
YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS



**WELLINGTON
RACE CLUB**

**Time to think about
booking your party
tent for the 2026
Wellington Boot.**

Phone: 0437 778 451



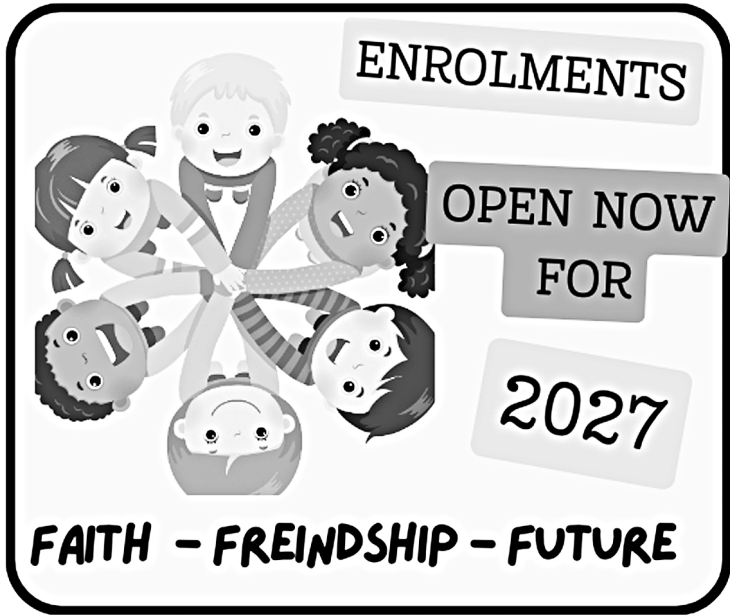
ST. COLUMBA'S CATHOLIC SCHOOL

Catholic Education Diocese of Bathurst Limited – ABN: 15679 442 089

38 FORBES STREET, YEOVAL, 2868

PH: 02 6846 4205

E: stcolumbas@bth.catholic.edu.au W: www.stcolumbas@bth.catholic.edu.au



3 Way Swimming Carnival



2026 OPENING MASS WELCOME NEW KINDER & NEW FAMILIES.



Southern Reigonal Swimming



CONGRATULATION TO MORGAN OUR SCHOOL CAPITAN AND GEORGIA AS SCHOOL PREFECTS





Under 16s girls rugby competition kicks off

THE UNDER 16s Girls rugby competition officially kicked off on Friday night, with Wellington and Dubbo joining forces to form a combined side for the 2026 season.

Despite going down 14–0 in their opening match and 17–0 in their second game, the scoreboard did not reflect the determination and skill displayed by the team.

The girls showed tremendous grit throughout both fixtures and competed strongly against quality opposition.

The forwards laid a solid foundation, dominating in contact and producing strong hit-ups that consistently gained valuable metres.

Their physical presence set the tone early, giving the backs quality ball to work with.

Out wide, the backs moved the ball confidently, showing speed and composure as they tested the defensive line with some impressive runs.

Lineouts proved to be a major strength, with the

team winning their own ball with ease.

This created multiple opportunities to improve field position and apply pressure, highlighting the growing cohesion between the Wellington and Dubbo players.

Officials from Central West Rugby were highly impressed with the standard of play across all teams on the night, noting the skill level and commitment on display as a positive sign for the future of the girls’ game in the region.

The team now travels to Orange tomorrow night, Friday, March 7, before returning home for their next home game on Friday, March 13, which is set to be a special occasion for the side.

The girls are encouraging the local rugby community to come along, show their support, and get behind these talented young athletes as they continue to build momentum throughout the season.

Carmen Gain



Wellington Amateur Swimming Club’s Dowton brothers Lakyn and Roman in their Western Area T-shirts have plowed through personal bests in each of their strokes at local and regional level. They were competing in the Speedo Sprints on Saturday. Roman swam in the NSW Country Championships in Sydney recently with top performances to crown him among the top 10 swimmers. The Clubs championships will be held in the near future at our local Olympic pool.



Time to check out Men’s Shed

LAST SATURDAY Wellington Men’s Shed had a stall at the Wellington Markets not only to sell a few items but to let the folks of Wellington and district know that they not only make things but also repair things that Tradies are not interested in.

Jim Titley, a Men’s Shed member Jim Titley said the Shed has a wood work section and a metal work section, “but that doesn’t mean you can’t participate.”

“We have members from all walks of life, the trades, truck drivers, accountants, farmers, teachers, you name it,” he said.

Some come along just for a cuppa and a chat.

“If you, or you know someone who might like to see what we are about, pop in and check us out, you will certainly be made welcome.”

The Shed is located at 59 Gobolion Street during the mornings of Monday, Wednesday and Friday.



Wellington Buddhist Centre is a regular at the Wellington markets. Ven Choden on duty. 18 THURSDAY, MARCH 5, 2026, WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER

Powerful statewide action weed program to protect farming and public lands

THE STATE Government has announced delivery of one of the pivotal foundations of its Biosecurity Action Plan with the \$40.7 million NSW Weeds Action Program (WAP) guaranteeing for the first time four-year funding to local organisations to combat the impact of priority weeds.

Strengthening and streamlining NSW’s response to new and emerging high-risk weeds that can blight the landscape and impact farming productivity is being delivered through this new four-year funding for 97 Local Control Authorities (LCA) that are groups of local councils.

The move from an annual grant is the biggest reform the program has seen in more than 60 years and is an important part of the government’s Biosecurity Action Plan, designed to ensure the state’s \$25 billion-a-year primary industries continue to thrive.

This new ongoing funding model is introduced after undertaking a review into biosecurity to improve its implementation across the state, cut red tape and provide greater certainty to LCAs.

The program supports targeted surveillance and rapid biosecurity responses, and is building a robust statewide network to prevent, eradicate and contain priority weeds by undertaking a range of actions, such as:

- * Preventing Parthenium Weed entering NSW,
- * Preventing spread with the aim of

eradicating Parkinsonia and Tropical Soda Apple weeds,

- * Working with landholders to contain alligator weed, frogbit, Hudson pear, Harrisia cactus and sticky nightshade,
- * Instigating surveillance and rapid response resources to detect new high-risk weeds early and act quickly to stop their spread

These high-risk weed species, which can cause significant environmental and agricultural damage and pose serious health risks to livestock, wildlife and people, require urgent action to stop them from becoming more widely established.

The new Weeds Action Program strengthens weed biosecurity by providing stable funding for risk-based planning, compliance and education, and ensures accountability from the LCAs through biannual reporting and evaluation.

The modernisation of the program covers more than smarter funding it also includes increasing collaboration between government agencies, councils, and farmers groups.

Importantly the focus on improved strategic delivery and measurable outcomes will be able to inform the program’s effectiveness and demonstrate the value of taxpayers’ dollars.

Led by the NSW Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development, the new four-year program will be delivered in partnership with Local Land Services.

TOOHEYS

Wellington & District
LEADER

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial Club



Are you up for the challenge?

Wellington Boot 2026

TOOHEYS

GUYS AND DOLLS

CHALLENGE

If you're aged 18 to 30 years you're eligible to enter the 2026 Tooheys Guys and Dolls Challenge at the Wellington Boot Racing Carnival, Friday, April 10 and Sunday April 12.

Entry forms available at Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club or on the club's website.

You must attend the Calcutta 6pm Saturday night (April 11) to win a horse, and gain free entry to Sunday's Boot Day, as guest of Wellington Race Club including lunch and drinks.

Prizes to challengers who pick 1st, 2nd, 3rd placings

Transgrid’s latest cost blowout raises a key question: What was the point of privatising energy networks?

By Tristan Edis the Director – Analysis and Advisory at Green Energy Markets.

It has recently hit the news that transmission company Transgrid is seeking to pass-onto consumers \$1.1 billion of a \$1.5 billion blow out in the construction costs of Project EnergyConnect.

It’s important to put this blow-out in context, because it is by no means a small blow-out.

Originally when Transgrid persuaded the Australian Energy Regulator to approve this project as good for consumers, it was projected that its share of the project cost would be \$1.82 billion.

So under Transgrid’s watch this project’s cost has blown out by 82%.

It’s also not small relative to the size of Transgrid’s overall asset base, which was \$7.65 billion in 2021-22.

One would expect that one of Transgrid’s core capabilities that consumers pay them for is the management of construction risks associated with building transmission lines.

But according to Transgrid’s shareholders they shouldn’t have to bear even a third of this risk.

Yet this is just the tip of the iceberg for a far bigger issue: if the shareholders in network monopolies aren’t prepared to wear the core and highly obvious risks associated with their business, why did we privatise these things in the first place?

This extends well beyond Project EnergyConnect to issues related to whether electricity and gas network shareholders should be immune from any loss in revenue associated with declining consumer demand for network capacity due to electrification (for gas networks) or energy efficiency, solar and batteries (for electricity networks).

Our electricity networks and a large proportion of our gas networks were constructed by government entities who were able to finance construction at very low interest rates linked to government bond markets.

Governments in Australia as well as those of major stable economies around the world can raise finance at interest rates well below what competitive market-exposed private sector companies can do because of their ability to raise incomes by fiat via taxes, as well as their ability to set prices for certain goods if they wish.

So why on earth would we hand this role to the private sector and pay them a significant premium over and above what government can finance this infrastructure for?

This is an especially pertinent question in relation to network assets when you consider:

– The vast majority of the costs associated with energy networks relate to paying for their construction and therefore paying back financiers.

The operating and maintenance costs are small.

– These provide an essential service that has historically been a monopoly, so until very recently we have had limited ability to rely on competition to discipline providers to keep their prices to consumers aligned with efficient costs.

Yet we privatised them, nonetheless. Or in the case of Queensland and NSW electricity networks, we regulate them as if they were a wholly private sector entity that was dependent on private sector financing options.

This was a bit of a half-way house towards privatisation known as corporatisation, but with NSW then following through to sell a large ownership stake in these networks (like Transgrid) to others.

The argument for why we did this was built on experience over the 1980s when it became apparent that government-owned, vertically integrated electricity companies (spurred in part by politicians’ wishes) had been far too keen to spend money building new capacity without adequate regard to whether this capacity was needed or could be deferred.

In power generation, in particular, we had vastly more coal power generating capacity than needed. We were told that, by privatising these assets, the new private sector owners would be far more disciplined about spending money on new capacity, because if they built expensive capacity for which there wasn’t the demand, then they’d end up losing money and shareholders would quickly put that to a stop.

Should network shareholders be a protected species?

But when it came to energy networks we’ve failed to put the regulatory structures in place to ensure shareholders faced the same discipline that power generators face.

That is: if you fail to properly read market demand and technological change and the market ends up with too much capacity, then you will pay the consequences for that error by losing money on that investment.

Instead, in energy network regulation under our national regulatory regime that began in 2008, we provided shareholders (which perversely included Queensland and NSW state government treasuries who got to write the regulatory rules) with a free, one-sided option.

If demand grows then you can keep that upside.

But if demand goes down, or just doesn’t grow in line with the forecast you demanded the regulator accept for fear of supply outages? Well, you get to keep whatever you could fool the regulator into accepting.

What compounded this error is that while we’ve eliminated much of the risk facing these company’s shareholders, we’ve also assumed financing costs that assume that they do face meaningful risks.

This is embodied within weighted average costs of capital (WACC) decisions that are far higher than government bonds, as illustrated by the WACC diamonds which sit several percentage points higher than the 10 year government bond rate.

Yet not only that, network shareholders also get to recover extra costs associated with above-normal inflation while those that buy government bonds have to cop that loss on the chin.

Plus, there are a range of other opportunities for networks to earn extra returns over and above the regulated WACC that mean electricity network shareholders made profits 70 per cent greater than the regulator allowance, while gas pipeline shareholders made profits 90% greater than the regulator allowance.

One-side framework

This one-sided option regulatory framework has created an incredibly perverse incentive for dishonest behaviour by energy networks.

There is no penalty for lying to the regulator, only upside.

What makes this worse is that while we assumed the owners of these networks faced costs of capital in line with risk-facing private sector entities, many are still government entities.

That obviously includes the Queensland and NSW State Treasuries, but also the Singaporean Government (Singapore Power), the Chinese Government (State Grid Corporation of China), Qatari Government (the Qatar Investment Authority); and several Canadian Governments’ public sector pension funds.

This has opened up the opportunity for these government entities to make a tidy sum arbitraging the difference between the low cost they pay to raise capital versus what the regulator lets them charge Australian energy consumers.

These distorted incentives led to tens of billions of dollars being spent expanding network assets that means we now have electricity networks with vastly more capacity than residential consumers need across large parts of east coast of Australia (note to dynamic pricing enthusiasts: the Australian Energy Market Commission has stated these won’t apply in areas of the network that have spare capacity – which is most of it).

It also means that gas networks have encouraged and eagerly connected lots of additional customers to their networks with little concern to whether long-term use of these pipelines was consistent with governments’ climate change goals.

Is the customer always right, or should the customer be forced to compensate for the network planner’s errors?

Meanwhile, large rises in the prices of electricity and gas have led consumers (often encouraged by governments in order to lower carbon emissions) to look for technological substitutes to using these networks – more energy-efficient equipment (which includes electrifying gas appliances) as well as solar and batteries.

Unfortunately, our energy rule maker – The Australian Energy Market Commission or AEMC – thinks consumers should be permanently saddled with the costs of this network capacity which they don’t need to use, through forcing a fixed charge upon them which they are unable to avoid, irrespective of their demand for network capacity at peak times.

Quite incredibly, those keen on this idea try to paint households that choose to be energy efficient, or adopt solar and batteries, or who are just frugal in their use of energy, as being free-loading, cross-subsidised parasites on the energy system.

This is an extraordinary reversal of the adage that the customer is always right.

Instead, we have a group of people that want us to believe that the production planner is always right.

Meanwhile customers that don’t conform to a planner’s forecast have done something wrong and should be made

to pay more to compensate for the planner’s error.

Not only that, apparently these people should be punished for the fact that landlords’ failure to provide well insulated and energy efficient homes has left renters especially vulnerable to network monopolies.

Side note: A household with a battery will place a low burden on the need for network capacity during the peak period even in winter

At this point, I should note there is a myth and a red herring promoted by both the AEMC and other supporters of hiking the fixed charge.

Myth

This is that households with batteries and solar should have to pay the same as an energy guzzling household because the solar and battery owner will place a burden on peak grid capacity equivalent to what they would have done without solar and battery system.

The reasoning is that in winter there will be times when the solar panels will be unable to fill the battery and the battery won’t do anything to reduce the household’s load on the network at the peak demand period (usually between 4pm to 9pm).

This is a myth because the typical battery being installed in households is 20kWh or more and can easily cover most household’s peak-period load even if they’ve fully electrified.

Sure, it may not be able to fully charge off solar, but under the existing tariff rules there is an incentive for the battery to be charged up from the grid at an off-peak period.

So their need for grid capacity at the peak period will remain far lower than other households.

It is also a red herring because, if you just stick with the existing rules for cost-reflective pricing where people are required to pay high charges during the peak demand period (which could be via a demand charge or even a dynamic network charge), that solar and battery household will pay a high charge for the network anyway, if they turn out to use a lot of network capacity at the peak period.

There is no need to shift to a fixed charge in order to ensure fair cost recovery for solar and battery owners who might still push up network peak demand due to a failure to charge-up their battery.

Escaping the absurdity that networks are always right even when they’re wrong

The AEMC and also the Australian Energy Regulator (AER) have attempted to blinker our vision to one where consumers who have made network forecasters look stupid are somehow to blame for the plight of renters dealing with an uncomfortable home that is costly to keep warm.

This is completely and utterly absurd.

It just doesn’t have to be this way, and it shouldn’t be this way.

There is an imminently sensible option available to our regulatory institutions (which oddly they have studiously avoided mentioning) to deal with declining demand for network assets.

It would involve the regulatory rules being changed to embody a principle that most consumers take for granted – that customers should only pay a supplier for what they actually need and use.

Back in 2012 the Major Energy Users proposed a change to the regulatory rules.

This would require the regulator to review the valuation of all network assets when assessing the asset base as part of a network revenue determination to ensure only necessary assets, appropriately sized for the service, are included in the asset base.

The asset base would only allow a return on assets to the extent they are used by consumers.

In other words, if network assets were deemed to be excess to customers’ needs they would be excluded from earning revenue until such time as they were needed.

At the time, the AEMC rejected this rule change request claiming, “Little empirical evidence has been provided on the extent to which electricity network assets are under-utilised.”

Well several years down the track that empirical evidence is now in (although it was pretty obvious even back then).

Across all jurisdictions network utilisation is substantially worse than it was in 2006 when the AER began collecting these statistics (with the exception of the Northern Territory which has always been horrible).

It’s now over a decade since the AEMC declared they needed to see more evidence and network utilisation hasn’t shown any sign of a dramatic turnaround of improvement.



LOCALITY PLAN.



DRAWING SCHEDULE.

NO.	DESCRIPTION	NO.	DATE
01	CONTRACT	001	24/03/2025
02	DECK & SHADE PLAN	002	24/03/2025
03	SECTION PLAN	003	24/03/2025
04	ELEVATION	004	24/03/2025
05	DETAILS & ASSEMBLY	005	24/03/2025

PROJECT DESCRIPTION.

For the purpose of the Building Code of Australia, No. 1, 2022, the development may be described as follows:

Classification: ACC 1, Type 1a
The building has been classified as a Class 1a building - residential.

Use: ACC 1, Type 1a
The building has been classified as a Class 1a building - residential.

Effective height: ACC 1, Type 1a
The building has been classified as a Class 1a building - residential.

Level of construction required: ACC 1, Type 1a
The building has been classified as a Class 1a building - residential.

Other notes: ACC 1, Type 1a
The building has been classified as a Class 1a building - residential.

GENERAL NOTES.

In addition to the National Construction Code, Building Code of Australia No. 1, 2022, the Building Code of Australia, No. 1, 2022, is also applicable to the building. The following notes are provided for the building:

1. The building shall be constructed in accordance with the Building Code of Australia, No. 1, 2022.

2. The building shall be constructed in accordance with the Building Code of Australia, No. 1, 2022.

3. The building shall be constructed in accordance with the Building Code of Australia, No. 1, 2022.

4. The building shall be constructed in accordance with the Building Code of Australia, No. 1, 2022.

5. The building shall be constructed in accordance with the Building Code of Australia, No. 1, 2022.

6. The building shall be constructed in accordance with the Building Code of Australia, No. 1, 2022.

7. The building shall be constructed in accordance with the Building Code of Australia, No. 1, 2022.

8. The building shall be constructed in accordance with the Building Code of Australia, No. 1, 2022.

9. The building shall be constructed in accordance with the Building Code of Australia, No. 1, 2022.

10. The building shall be constructed in accordance with the Building Code of Australia, No. 1, 2022.

WELLINGTON GOLF CLUBHOUSE - DECK/SHADES

WELLINGTON, NSW 2820



Club Expansion - Wellington Golf Club

By acquiring the Wellington Golf Club and 18-hole course, this club can now increase functions and entertainment utilising the golf club premises and the acclaimed course facilities just a few kilometres out of town and next to the world famous Wellington Caves and tourist park.

This enables an expansion of this club's scope of potential income streams while servicing the whole community in town and throughout the Wellington region with an ultra-class golf course and indoor and outdoor facilities ready for any type of function from weddings to

christening parties to wakes.

ABOVE: An artist's impression of the club's outdoors area fitted with sundeck and shading, making the club an ideal venue for any function.



Swim Pointscore

- Carmen Gain photos



Touch Semi-Finals - Jo Ivey Photos

Grand Final night caps off exciting Wellington Touch season

Games played as the Leader went to press.

WELLINGTON TOUCH Association's 2025-26 season reached its climax last night with Grand Finals across all three grades of the Squadron Energy Cup and Remain Ivey Junior Competition at Pioneer Park.

It has been a thrilling finals series across all grades, with several matches decided by the narrowest of margins, and last night's promise to deliver more of the same with bragging rights and prize money on the line did not disappoint.

In A Grade, last week FORME booked their Grand Final spot early with a convincing 9-6 semi-final win over Fast Eddie Owens Plumbing, while Wolf Pack defeated Bell River Hay 4-2 in the other semi.

Fast Eddie Owens Plumbing then fought their way back through the preliminary final to earn a second crack at FORME in what shaped as a fascinating rematch.

The A Grade decider kicked off at 7pm last night.

The B Grade finals have produced arguably the most entertaining matches of the series.

NF Electrical cruised into the Grand Final with a dominant 9-3 semi-final win over Lousicks, while Let It Snow scraped past Arthurville 4-3 in a nail-biter.

The preliminary final between Lousicks and Let It Snow was another classic, with Let It Snow prevailing 6-5 to set up a date with NF Electrical in the Grand Final at 6:20pm last night.

The Tremain Ivey Junior competition's C Grade has been just as tightly contested.

Wello Weapons edged Swamp Kings 3-2 in the semi-final to earn a direct route to the Grand Final.

Touch Downs squeezed past Junior Cowboys 7-6 in the other semi but were unable to maintain their momentum in the preliminary final, going down to a resurgent Swamp Kings side 8-3.

Wello Weapons and Swamp Kings met in the C Grade Grand Final at 5:40pm.

The D Grade competition continues to provide a wonderful introduction to touch football for Wellington's youngest players, with Round 13 kicking off proceedings from 5pm.

The D Grade players were treated to a pizza party to celebrate the end of their season.

Wellington's top referees were appointed to officiate all Grand Final matches.

Grand Final results and photos in the Leader next week

Abe Dearmer



Golfing News

Tim Parker and Doug Ney return to form

TIM PARKER and Doug Ney returned to the winner's circle in their Individual Stableford A and B grades respectively.

As the fields are still quite large, grade categories continued also for the further encouragement to players.

Tim (I'm back) Parker who compiled a great 39pts to win A grade was followed by runner-up Richard Agar with 37pts on a countback.

The "goss" that Doug Ney couldn't keep the smile off his face as he finished with 39pts to win B grade, and with just one point behind for runner-up was Bryan Kiss.

Nearest the pin on 3rd was Josh Bullock, 8th John Donnelly, 14th George Hollow, 16th Jeremy Barton.

Nearest the pin in two shots on the 13 was David East.

Long drives went to Matt Ringland in A grade and Doug Ney in B grade.

Brent Eather Encouragement award was hotly contested again with 23pts being the benchmark, winner was Nate Conn, but a special mention of Paul Hannelly who is getting closer to an award win.

Wednesday's ladies start their 2026 season with a Ransom event plus the 9-hole competition.

Winner of the 18-hole Ransom was Lou Taylor and Cathy Loo-Shui who combined

brilliantly to leave the field well behind with a final score of 88pts.

Runners up were Marion Conn and Marie Cornish with 59pts.

NTP's were Denise Haesler and Teena Campbell and she sunk the putt as well, nice Birdie.

Nine-hole competition results for the past couple of weeks has seen Wendy Slack-Smith and Kim Brien win rounds.

This comp is open to members and non-members.

Thursday's Individual Stableford was won by Nathan Stewart who compiled an excellent 40pts. Runner-up was Joe Ryan finishing with 38pts.

Iberdrola, Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club 9-hole competition Round 19 resulted with a win for Rod McMahon with a 33nett.

Runner-up was Lewis Payne who finished with 34nett.

Leaders after Round 19 are Joe, Adam, David Ryan, Tim Parker and Gary McCarroll leading with -12.

Last round of this comp is now March 19 with presentation on March 27.

Last Saturday's Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer Competition Semi-Finals resulted with Dirty Birds defeating Maulers 2up and The Masters defeated Bell River Bandits 1up.

Final now has Dirty Birds taking on The Masters which will be a very close affair. Play-off for third will be Maulers taking on Bell River Bandits and there will be some long bombs in this match.

J and B Cup Finals, Matchplay Championships: A grade, Kurt Cusack v David O'Brien, Mitchell Cusack or David East v John Gersbach, John Donnelly v Mathew Redfern, Elton Keefe v Gary Cusack.

B grade, David Hyde v Daniel McCullum, Rod McMahon v Wayne Lang, Steven McCarroll v Tim Parker, Noel Stanford v Stephen Whiteman.

C grade, Rod Irwin v bye, Warren Williams v John Southwell, Drew Stone v bye, Cody Conn v Ron Cowan.

Kiss Trophy draw with Round 1 to be played by March 14 - B Kiss v Bye, W Bruce v R Cowan, R Baker v Rod McMahon, Brock Naden v David O'Brien, P Neuenhaus v D Stone, D East v P West, D Bell v Pat Slack-Smith, Rod Irwin v Norm Royal, B Eather v Wayne Lang, Kurt Cusack v Bye, J Barton v M Cornish, C Royal v M Ringland R Pedron v Rod Miller, Nathan Stewart v J Gersbach, N Stanford v G Hollow, D Naveau v M

Payne, J Bullock v D Hyde, K Reid v Bye, D Ney v Daniel McCullum, Tim Parker v R Parnell, P Holden v A Ryan, S Whiteman v M Conn, D Haesler v E Keefe, J Ryan v Bye, J Donnelly v D Wilson, W Slack-Smith v A Brien, J Fleming v A Bullock, J Armstrong v R Agar, G McNaughton v L Conn, M Britton v Gary Cusack, J Southwell v D Ryan, S Kiss v Bye.

Club Centenary Celebration

Don't forget the Four-Person Ambrose the feature of the golf club's centenary on March 15.

Cost for the day is \$25 for golf, Dinner is a further \$25.

Bookings are filling fast and can be made at the Golf Club by this Saturday, March 8. Tee times are from 10am till 12pm.

There will be no transport to the Golf Club, but transport will be available for your return home.

Preferred Lies are still in effect through the GREEN.

This Saturday's events are the Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club March Monthly Medal, plus the Final and third placing of Wellington Mowers and Chainsaws Summer Comp, and the George Hollow Putting Competition.

19th Hole

TOOHEYS

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Wellington Boot 2026
TOOHEYS
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POKER NIGHT
THE ULTIMATE POKER TOUR
IS BACK AT THE CLUB
FRIDAY 6 MARCH | AT 7:30 PM
Play Now
Wellington Soldiers
Memorial Club

THEN & FUTURE

WELLINGTON GOLF CLUB'S
100th Anniversary
Celebration!



Sunday 15th March
Early AM start 4-Man Ambrose followed by
sausage sizzle, then 4-8pm entertainment,
complementary dinner & fun for the kids

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ARTHUR STREET, WELLINGTON | **INFORMATION FOR MEMBERS AND THEIR GUEST**

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LAST STAND
CHISEL BARNES SHOW
FRIDAY 10TH APRIL
PLUS
Boot Weekend
The OZ
Rock
Show



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A TRIBUTE TO
GOLD
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AND
JIMMY BARNES

IT PAYS TO BE A MEMBER!
MEMBERS EXCLUSIVE
HOME APPLIANCE GIVEAWAY
PLUS \$500 CASH!



We're giving away \$4,500 worth of appliances
PLUS \$500 cash!
Just swipe your card when purchasing drinks or
playing the pokies to go in the draw.
Automatic entries Must be in the Club to win
Join now and swipe your way to a home upgrade!

WELLINGTON
Soldiers Memorial Club

RISING AUSTRALIAN COUNTRY MUSIC
ARTIST AND PROUD WIRADJURI
SINGER-SONGWRITER
NATHAN LAMONT


performing at Wellington Soldiers Club
Saturday, 7th March 7:30pm!
A night not to be missed!

24 THURSDAY, MARCH 5, 2026, WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER